



LODA
LOCAL ADMINISTRATIVE ENTITIES
DEVELOPMENT AGENCY

VISION UMURENGE PROGRAM OPERATIONAL MANUAL

SAFETY NET COMPONENTS

JULY 2023

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0. Introduction

The Vision Umurenge Programme was established in 2008 under the Ministry of Local Government (MINALOC). Originally established as a flagship programme within the first and second Economic Development and Poverty Reduction Strategy (EDPRS), the VUP remains a key mechanism for the delivery of a range of national targets under National Strategy for Transformation (NSTI-2018-2024).

VUP program has 4 components namely:

- Safety Nets,
- Graduation component
- Shock responsive component
- Sensitisation and Public Communications.

This operational manual covers the Safety Net component's schemes including classic Public Works (cPW), expanded Public Works Labor based (ePW) expanded Public Works service based: Community/ Home Based Early Child Development (C/HBECD), Nutrition Sensitive Direct Support (NSDS) Old Age Grant (OAG) and Direct Support (DS).

0.1. Establish Annual Targets

Annual targets for all safety nets will be established from the Sector Strategic Plan and the guidance in the Planning and Budgeting Call Circular. The targets will include:

- Geographic scale up/coverage (the sectors where the safety nets will be implemented)
- The number of recipients to be covered and the % of eligible recipients to be covered in each sector;
- The transfer value and other costs
- For cPW the number of working days for each recipient

0.2. Establish Geographic Scale Up Plans

DS and **OAG** are at national coverage and these will remain. **cPW**, **ePW-LB** and **ePW-H/CBECD** are not in all sectors but will be scaled up as resource allows.

The number of sectors covered within a district depends on proportion of national caseload of extremely poor households residing in a district according to recent EICV and regular data updates from the Social Protection Systems, as shown in Box I.

Box I: Summary of methodology for identifying VUP public works sectors

The number of sectors targeted for VUP in a district shall be determined with reference to the proportion of extremely poor households living in that district as follows:

$$\frac{\text{Number of people living in extreme poverty in district (latest EICV data/SR)}}{\text{Total number of people living in extreme poverty in Rwanda (EICV/SR)}} \times \text{Total nbr of sectors targeted for VUP PW}$$

- During scale up of ePW-H/CBECD, sectors with highest number of households in extreme poverty with children aged 0-5 will be prioritised in each district.
- On the other hand, sectors prone to the impact of climate related shocks will be given high consideration during the scale up of cPW.
- The scale up of NSDS will be prioritised based on:
 - i. Stunting prevalence in the District (Data source: DHS)

- ii. Proportion of households in a District with poor and extremely poor HH (Source: EICV)
- iii. Proportion of household which are moderately food insecure (Source: CFSVA). Sectors implementing the NSDS will also be required to comply with a number of key 'readiness criteria'.

0.3. Principles for Payment Delivery and procedures

0.3.1. Principles for payments delivery

- Recipients shall receive their full entitlement. In the event of delays to the validation of the targeting list, validated households shall receive payments based on the date the Sector Council approved the enrollment lists;
- Payments must be made through formal financial institutions where recipients can choose a payment method most convenient to them (e.g., Bank account, MNO or SACCOs)¹;
- Payments must be made from District accounts at BNR into individual recipients' accounts. Funds should not flow through Sector accounts.
- Payments shall be processed in MEIS by District staff each month for DS, OAG and ePW, each quarter for NSDS and 10 days working cycle for cPW. However, DS and OAG payments for the June payroll shall be approved by District not later than 15th June to allow early targeting process for the following year. The payroll list for other programs should be similarly processed in advance based on their timeline for each payment cycle.
- Financial institutions supporting payment delivery should provide a report confirming payment status or reconciliation report to each district/ sector administration after each payment cycle which can be directly uploaded to the MEIS by sector administration during tracking process.
- Funds for payments must be transferred to the participating financial institutions in a timely manner, recipients should ideally be able to access their monthly transfers within the month for which they are due and certainly not later than 10 calendar days after the end of that month.
- Recipients who cannot travel to their bank/SACCO branch to access payments or who are not allowed to open their own accounts (e.g., those under 18 years of age) may authorise a trusted representative to collect the money on their behalf. This should be recorded in the **Minutes of the Annual Targeting List Validation Meeting** as per **annex I**.

0.3.2. Payment procedures

Step I: Sector - To create payroll and payroll order from MEIS and forward to District

For cPW intermediary steps to reach step I are required:

- *Daily completion of VUP cPW Attendance Sheet by Capitas;*
- *Compilation and approval of Attendance List by Community Representative (every 10 working days);*
- *Endorsement of VUP cPW attendance form by Site Supervisor and submission to Sector;*
- *Sector reviews and endorses attendance lists and authorises MEIS data entry;*
- *Data entry of attendance list data into MEIS by site supervisor (data should be entered within 3 days of completion of the work period)*
- *Sector - To verify data entered by cPW sector supervisor and create payroll from MEIS and forward to District*

¹ For population groups that do not have a transaction account at a formal financial institution, the program should put in place an account opening process with a partner financial institution along with specific activities to build awareness on accessing and using their account.

Step 2: District - Processing and Transfer of Funds to SACCO/ Financial Institutions

Step 3: Sector – Submission of payroll order to Sacco/ Financial Institutions

Step 4: SACCO/ Financial Institutions – Payments (Crediting) to recipients 'accounts

Step 5: SACCO - Reconciliation and payment confirmation to sector using the following template:

SACCO NAME:	
Payroll reconciliations report for the month of /20.....	
Component: DS, OAG, ePW,	
Particulars	Amounts (Rwf)
A. Funds transferred by districts	xxxx
B. Less Amounts Credited to Recipients Accounts	(xxxx)
C. Unpaid Amounts (A-B)	xxxx
D. Add Opening Unpaid amounts from the previous months	xxxx
E. Less Amounts Credited to Recipients Accounts for Unpaid amounts from the previous months	(xxxx)
F. Less Unpaid Amounts Refunded to Districts	(xxxx)
G. Closing Unpaid amounts	xxxx

Prepared on (date) by:
SACCO Accountant

Approved by:
SACCO Manager

Notes to the payroll reconciliation report:

- i. Closing Unpaid Amounts (to be divided into the month under which the report is being prepared and previous months) should be supported by a list of their recipients showing the reasons for not being paid and this list should be an appendix to the payroll reconciliation report.
- ii. A copy of a cheque/payment order (with a reception) of Unpaid Amounts Refunded to Districts should be attached to the payroll reconciliation report as a proof.
- iii. A payroll reconciliation report should be prepared by SACCO for every payment and be sent to the sector administration within 30 days following the payroll reception date by SACCO. This report will be accompanied with a letter of a payment confirmation from which a sector social affairs officer will base on to track the payment in the MEIS. The letter will contain the figure of A, B & C of the above Payroll reconciliation report.

Step 6: Sector: To confirm payment completion in MEIS (payment tracking) by uploading payment confirmation from SACCO in MEIS.

Step 7: Sacco - Refunds of any unpaid amounts to District within 2 months following the payroll reception date by SACCO

0.4. Planning and budgeting process

0.4.1. Planning and budgeting for Direct Support

- The VUP Direct Support and Old Age Grant schemes shall be the first priority within the VUP and shall be fully funded at all times.
- Budget ceilings for DS and Old Age Grant shall be set for each sector
- Budget ceilings for VUP's Direct Support and Old Age Grant schemes shall be estimated by LODA during BCCI on the basis of:

- a) 100% coverage of currently enrolled households
 - b) 12 months of payments;
 - c) Anticipated bank charges associated with monthly payments, costs for opening bank accounts for new entrants including other administrative costs such as photography charges etc.
 - d) Household entitlements which shall be set as per the annual guidance issued by LODA
- Following the issuance of the local government development budget ceiling in each year (PBCC2), LODA will inform the districts of the budget ceiling for Direct Support entitlements in each sector. The budget ceiling for DS and Old Age Grant in each sector will be based on:
 - a) Anticipated number of recipients (as per the recently updated targeting list)²;
 - b) Annual entitlement value (based on: the size of each eligible HH; the associated monthly payment rate; and 12 months of payments);
 - c) Anticipated bank charges; costs for opening bank accounts for new entrants including photography charges.
 - Districts will enter the budget details into IFMIS in compliance with the budget ceiling.
 - By end of June each year, districts will revalidate their DS and Old Age Grant targeting lists in each sector for the next financial year.
 - Final DS and Old Age Grant budgets for each sector must be entered into MEIS by end of July each year, ensuring that the entered budget complies with the budget ceiling.
 - The DS and Old Age Grant budget should be reviewed at Mid Year Budget Review (MYBR) to ensure it is sufficient to cater for all eligible households (including any households that have become eligible since June). However, Districts should not wait until MYBR to start paying any newly enrolled households.

0.4.2. Planning and budgeting for Public Works schemes (cPW and ePW)

0.4.2.1. Detailed district planning process

Planning Step 1: Community-level identification of potential public works projects

The selection of public works projects should be driven by a participatory planning process in order to promote the identification and prioritization of community needs. Hence, planning begins with the Umudugudu identifying key outcomes it wishes to achieve and then developing a list of projects that will achieve these outcomes. Bottom-up planning will be complemented by national guidelines and strategic plans (the environmental, agricultural, soil and water management plans). Districts and technical ministries could shortlist together those which are suitable for labour intensive production.

Planning Step 2: Simplified Feasibility Assessments

Simplified feasibility assessments shall be prepared for all VUP Public Works projects i.e cPW and ePW projects. Ideally these feasibility studies should be prepared well in advance of PBCCI and PPD preparation so that detailed design information is available during the annual planning process. District should work hand in hand with relevant sector ministry as part of their regular planning (e.g. soil or water management plans). These should be prepared by relevant Sector

² In the event that eligibility policy changes and data on the number of eligible households is not available for budgeting purposes, statistical estimates shall be used to set the budget.

technical staff (e.g. Sector land manager and infrastructure management officer, Sector Agronomist, Sector Forestry Officer) under supervision of District technical staff (district engineer, agronomist and Forestry). Guidelines for conducting simplified feasibility assessments are provided in **Annex 2 for both cPW and ePW**. It is important that Simplified Feasibility Assessments provide sufficient information to allow the District Environment Officer to conduct environmental and social screening of the project.

Planning Step 3: Annual selection of PW projects

On an annual basis, districts and sectors shall be informed of their eligibility to implement cPW projects as part of the PBCCI process. In response to PBCCI, Umudugudu shall be asked to identify potential cPW projects which shall be reviewed and consolidated by the Cell and Sector administration.

The Sector shall submit its proposed projects to the District for review, approval and integration into the annual District Action Plan. Issues for consideration during prioritization include:

- i. Number of Households employed by ensuring equal benefit between women and men;
- ii. Projects attracting woman should be given high priority
- iii. Climate-sensitive and gender smart projects ³should be given high priority
- iv. Labour-intensity (minimum 70% but the aggregate at District level shall be 80%);
- v. Number of eligible households living close to proposed project site.

In selecting the projects, the District must respect national and Development Partners (funding the VUP programme) planning guidelines.

Box 2-Note on trans-Sector (Umurenge) projects

By principal a PW project is implemented within one sector. However, there is a possibility of implementing a big cPW project crossing more than one sector with the purpose of job creation for many people and improving their livelihoods. cPW recipients can only work on the site of the project that runs through their Sector.

A final list of approved projects, which will depend on the budget available, will be posted at Sector offices and communicated to communities through Cell General Assemblies.

³ A climate-sensitive project can be defined as project that is highly sensitive to the impacts of climate change and can contribute to disaster risk reduction, and climate adaptation/resilience and mitigation (IFRS, 2022; Na Shen et al., 2020; IFC, 2011). While Gender-smart projects address the gaps in inclusion of women and their active participation in implementation in order to reduce equally vulnerabilities and disadvantages faced and boost socioeconomic outcomes for both women and men.

Box 3– Types of projects

The following types of projects are accepted to be implemented:

a. **Under Labour-intensive classic public works scheme:** Environmental management and climate change adaptation projects, such as radical terraces, progressive terraces, afforestation, re-afforestation, greening and beatification, tree nurseries establishment and rehabilitation of marshland drainage channels.

In the case of radical terraces projects, the implementation should be in line with technical standards set by Ministry of Agriculture.

b. **Under ePW:** Environmental management and climate change adaptation like greening and beatification, tree nurseries establishment, maintenance of community access roads and/or coupled with tree plantation and care services through C/HBECD

NB. The districts are discouraged to implement rehabilitation of community access roads project under cPW scheme due to the cost of non wages activities which are very important to make it sustainable. However, in case there is a need of workforce to rehabilitate community road, District must request non-objection from LODA. Projects that provide the maximum value to poorer households shall be prioritised during project selection.

Planning Step 4: Environmental and Social Screening

The District Environment Officer in collaboration with District and Sector staff in charge of public works implementation, will socially and environmentally pre-screen all selected cPW projects using the screening checklist within the SFA in Annex2. This must be completed in time to allow the pre-screening report to be submitted to LODA within the SFA and PPD at PBCCI. If the pre-screening identifies a need for social or environmental mitigation and the related site specific safeguard instrument was not yet submitted together with SFA, District will be requested to develop the instrument and SFA should be updated to include cost of mitigation activities.

Planning Step 5: Review of project proposals by the district and preparation of PPDs

Districts will review and select Public Works projects for submission to LODA. Issues for consideration during prioritization include:

- i. Labour-intensity (minimum 70% but the aggregate at District level shall be 80%)
- ii. Number of recipients vis-à-vis sector VUP Public Works targets
- iii. Number of working days per household
- iv. Whether the project is located in a Cell with a high number of eligible households.
- v. Contribution to pro-poor economic development and reducing vulnerability to climate change

Districts will enter Project Profile Document templates (PPDs) and upload the Simplified Feasibilities Assessments (and its associated environmental and social screening report) into the LODA MEIS.

The PPDs will include:

- i. Anticipated number of workers on the project;
- ii. Number of day work to be provided to each participating household;
- iii. The total number of working days generated by the project

- iv. Projected recipient and non-recipient costs of the project where:
 - The recipient budget is sufficient to pay the number of working days generated by the project at the prevailing wage rate
 - Non wages costs should be between 20% to 30% **but 20% should be the average at District level** for cPW and 20% for ePW of the total project cost.
- v. Wage rates should be set in line with prevailing unskilled wage rates for a full working day but shall not be lower than the prevailing market /official applicable minimum wage rate

Planning Step 6: Review of proposed projects to LODA

LODA will quality-assure PPDs, SFAs and screening reports entered into MEIS to ensure compliance with planning guidelines. LODA will officially provide comments to the District and shall only recommend approval of VUP Classic CPW projects that comply with guidelines.

Districts should adjust PPDs in line with these comments and submit the final PPDs for approval to the District Council. Thereafter data entry into IFMIS may proceed. **Once the project has been entered into IFMIS, changes may only be made at mid-year budget review and approved by District Council.**

0.4.2.2. Detailed district budgeting process

MINECOFIN will issue Planning & Budget Call Circular 2 in January/February each year which will provide guidelines under which Districts will prepare their detailed budgets. LODA will assist Districts to review budget execution in December each year and propose reallocations of district budgets in the Budget Review as necessary. The impact of budget revision must be entered into MEIS.

Budgeting Step 1: PBCC2 issued and PPDs updated for actual District/sector budget ceilings

- i. LODA will provide districts with detailed budget ceilings per programme and component and sector.
- ii. The budget ceilings will be based on the number of predicted recipients in each sector based on a review of the Systems' database and the numbers of recipients working on proposed projects in the PPDs;
- iii. Districts will then review the number of recipients which LODA has predicted are eligible for ePW and cPW and discuss with LODA any significant variation
- iv. Districts will update the approved PPDs in MEIS to comply with sector-level budget ceilings.

In the event the budget ceiling is insufficient to sustain the projects planned on the PPDs, the first priority will be to provide funds to ePW projects and then to cPW ongoing projects. The District may then take the following measures to ensure that recipients are provided with work:

- i. Reduce in coverage rate i.e number of recipients or sector covered;
- ii. As a final consideration Districts may discuss with LODA whether the number of working days per HH could be reduced for cPW

Budgeting Step 2: Entry of project and budget into MEIS project module

During Planning Process, PPDs and SFAs are entered in MEIS.

When entering projects in MEIS the Districts will:

- i. Ensure that exactly the same project name is used in MEIS as in IFMIS including the designation ePW, ePW/ C/HBECD and cPW
- ii. Ensure that the projects are coded to the correct financial year
- iii. Ensure that the projects use the IFMIS activity code in MEIS to uniquely identify them
- iv. Ensure that funding sources are respected and the values agree to IFMIS

When entering projects into MEIS Districts must establish the appropriate contracts. For cPW projects the following contracts are required:

- i. PW recipients' payment contract (essential)
- ii. Materials and equipment contract (s) (essential)
- iii. Project site/ Sector supervision contract for cPW/ ePW-CHBECD and cell supervisor for ePW (as required)

Budgeting Step 3: Review of Projects entered into IFMIS

Only the projects with PPDs and SFAs approved by LODA can be entered into IFMIS

LODA will review projects entered into IFMIS for compliance with:

- i. Approved PPDs and SFAs
- ii. Projects budgeted in the targeted sectors
- iii. Budget ceilings for each funding source
- iv. Projects correctly coded to the IFMIS programme and sub-programme codes

On-going Projects - any projects expected to extend beyond the end of the current financial year should also be submitted to LODA at this point and should be funded as the first priority.

0.4.3. Planning and budgeting for NSDS

- The Budget ceilings for NSDS shall be set for each District
- Budget ceilings for NSDS shall be estimated by LODA during BCCI on the basis of:
 - i. 100% coverage of currently enrolled recipients
 - ii. 12 months of payments which is made every quarter;
 - iii. Anticipated bank charges associated with quarterly payments,
 - iv. Any cost associated with required NSDS coordination mechanisms
- Following the issuance of the local government development budget ceiling each year (BCC2), LODA will inform concerned districts about budget ceiling for NSDS entitlements and then, each concerned District will allocate budget to Sectors depending on number of recipients and available funds. The budget ceiling for NSDS will be set based on:
 - v. Anticipated number of recipients (as per the recently updated targeting list)⁴;
 - vi. Annual entitlement value (based on the monthly payment rate);
 - vii. Anticipated bank charges; costs related Coordination, evaluation and monitoring costs
- The annual budget ceilings will be adjusted during the budget revision by considering new cases registered in first half of the year and projection of new cases in the second half of the year to ensure that all enrolled eligible NSDS recipients are supported.
- Concerned Districts will enter the budget into IFMIS in compliance with the budget ceiling
- Final NSDS budgets for each sector must be entered into MEIS as soon as the national budget has been approved each year, ensuring that the entered budget complies with the budget

⁴ In the event that eligibility policy changes and data on the number of eligible households is not available for budgeting purposes, statistical estimates shall be used to set the budget.

ceiling. Any changes to the budget during the mid-year budget revision should also be entered into MEIS after the process of mid-year budget revision has been completed.

I. Direct Income Support

I.1. Direct support

I.1.1. Direct Support implementation process

The eligible DS recipients should comply with the following eligibility criteria:

- (a) Households with no labour capacity with no other source of income
- (b) the head of Households is a full time student and below 25 years of age and has no any other source of income.
- (c) Households with children below 18 years of age and has no other source of income.
- (d) HHs in extremely poor condition and have Only one worker caring for someone with severe disabilities (holding disability card provided by NCPD with category 1 and 2) or a person with severe disability who has not yet been categorized but demonstrating severe disability proved by community (but the district concerned should keep helping the concerned to get the card)
- (e) Household residing in a sector for at least 6 months

Note 1: In these guidelines, a person is qualified as able to work if he/she is aged between 18 and 65 years' old. A full time student aged between 18 and 25 years is not qualified as person able to work.

Note 2: A recipient of DS cannot benefit from other Government direct support programmes (MINUBUMWE, RDRC) or other VUP safety net programmes except NSDS.

Note 3: Any household benefiting from government grant or subsidy as a sole source of income shall not be considered as above cut-off because they don't have sustainable source of income.

I.1.2. Selection of Direct Support recipients

- (a) The provisional targeting list (PTL) of DS recipients is generated from the dynamic social registry and compare it with the previous financial year list of recipients;
- (b) Districts and sectors, using the community meeting/ consultation, verify the changes of each household socio-economic status and make adjustment to PTL;
- (c) The adjustments are due to household member's death, improvement of socio-economic status of households i.e having source of income, relocated households, new households complying with eligibility criteria or increase of household size;
- (d) The final targeting list (using annex 2) is approved by Sector council and
- (e) The approved targeting list is entered into the system used to monitor the implementation of this scheme.

I.1.3. Fund requests

- Funds for VUP Direct Support should be requested from MINECOFIN and LODA on a quarterly basis.
- Since the first DS payments of the year are due in July, districts should request funds for the July-September DS payments immediately at the start of the new financial year.
- Districts requesting funds from MINECOFIN should ensure that the DS budget is included in the cash flow plan of the District.
- Districts requesting funds from LODA shall submit the following supporting documents as set out in Box 4.

Box 4- Supporting information for DS fund requisitions

1. Letter of request from District;
2. Transfer Request Report generated from MEIS;
3. Sector council minutes approving the final list of eligible households.
4. List of eligible households (as approved by Sector Councils) in MEIS and associated quarterly transfer values

1.1.4. Payment principles and procedures

- DS recipients shall receive their full annual entitlement. In the event of delays to the annual validation of the targeting list, validated households shall receive payments based on the date the Sector Council approved the targeting lists except those who were approved in previous year and at the same time approved as new recipients;
- Funds for DS payments must be transferred to SACCO or other financial institutions and Recipients should ideally be able to access their monthly transfers within the month for which they are due and certainly not later than 10 calendar days after the end of that month,
- No deductions whatsoever shall be made from VUP DS payments during the payment process; however, for households who have lost a member, full payment shall be made based on the household size, but adjusted the following month based on the remaining household members,
- Districts should pay all enrolled recipients from the start of each financial year, ensuring that all enrolled households receive their full entitlement (either 12 months or from the date of enrolment depending on circumstances),
- In the event that a household has lost all the eligible household members, or the eligible households have migrated, payments for those households shall be withheld and returned to the District Accounts within 2 months.
- The adequacy of Direct Support household entitlement values shall be reviewed every 3 years by LODA and revised if necessary, will be implemented from the start of the next financial year.
- Household entitlement should be calculated using the following table:

Table 1 Household entitlement under DS

Number of HH members	Household entitlements in Frw
1	7,500
2	12,000
3	15,000
4	18,000
5+	21,000

1.1.5. Sensitisation

Direct Support recipients shall also benefit from sensitisation delivered by local government staffs, civil society organizations and/or other service providers.

These shall be provided on at least semester basis. Where para social workers are present, DS recipients may also benefit from their services.

Compliance with the above design and implementation principles is expected to maximise positive impacts on household food security, investment in livelihood activities and asset accumulation.

1.1.6. Coordination and reporting requirements

Direct Support should be integrated into the agenda of the monthly Cell, Sector and District-level coordination activities to allow effective escalation of issues between coordination levels and monitoring of resolution of issues arising. Sectors should incorporate VUP Direct Support into their general quarterly reports to the Districts. Districts should report on a quarterly basis to LODA & MINALOC and copy to Province. The same report shall be reported by Districts through MEIS on regular basis.

1.2. Old Age Grant

1.2.1. Objective

These guidelines aim to explain the implementation of the grant pillar for the elderly in need, with the purpose of improving their well-being and addressing issues associated with old age as outlined in the Vision Umurenge Program (VUP). The individuals referred to in these guidelines are elderly people aged 65 and above living in households with no assets (land, livestock, forests, etc.) or whose assets are too insufficient to sustain their wellbeing.

1.2.2. Fundamental Principals

- The grant for the elderly in need is calculated on an individual basis, not on the household size.
- The criteria for selecting grant recipients must be clear and based on the actual living conditions of the selected individuals during the selection period.
- The purpose of the grant is primarily to address basic and special needs due to old age and any personal life issues arising therefrom; it is strictly for the intended recipients and cannot be transferred to others.

1.2.3. Eligible recipients for the Old Age Grant

The grant is intended for any Rwandan **aged 65 and above** who is in need and living in the:

- (a) Households with no labour capacity and with no other source of income
- (b) HHs in extremely poor condition and have Only one worker caring for someone with severe disabilities (holding disability card provided by NCPD with category 1 and 2) or a person with severe disability who has not yet been categorized but demonstrating severe disability proved by community (but the district concerned should keep helping the concerned to get the card)
- (c) Household residing in a sector for at least 6 months

Note: A recipient of OAG cannot benefit from other Government direct support programmes (MINUBUMWE, RDRC) or other VUP safety net programmes except NSDS.

1.2.4. Selection of Old Age Grant recipients

An elderly Rwandan in need is defined as someone aged 65 and above. Initially this grant is meant for elderly individuals from households without labor capacity who were receiving direct support from the VUP program. The selection of old age grant recipients involves:

- The provisional targeting list (PTL) of OAG recipients is generated from the dynamic social registry and compare it with the previous financial year list of recipients;

- Using this MEIS, the social welfare officer at the sector level will generate a payroll list of the elderly in households receiving direct support;
- The generated payroll list is then approved by the Sector Executive Secretary;
- The approved list can be updated during the budget review, particularly when adding new recipients/ individuals or removing recipients/individuals any time when it is a death.
- For those who will receive DS but have reached old age, every month the system will display a list of recipients of OAG support based on the dates of birth of those who are already receiving DS support, that is, each month may have its own list that is different from the previous month.

1.2.5. Planning & budgeting and payment principles & procedures

The planning and budgeting process will be following and done together with the Direct Support (section 0.4.1.) and the payment process and procedures will follow the same process for Direct Support (section 1.1.4.) except the following:

- The grant is calculated individually, household members agree on the account (personal or joint account in case they are two or more within household) through which the grant will be disbursed, preferably in a financial institution (Umurenge SACCO or another bank if preferred)
- The grant amount increases proportionally for multiple elderly individuals in the household as shown below:

Table 2 Monthly Grant Amount for OAG

Number of Elderly Individuals	Monthly Grant Amount in Frw
1	8,500
2	17,000
3	25,500
4	34,000
5	42,500

Note: Individuals in the household under 65 years old continue receiving the ordinary direct support based on their number.

1.2.6. Requesting funds

Given that recipients will start receiving their grants from July, the funds for the Old Age Grant must be requested quarterly from MINECOFIN or LODA, starting with the first quarter (July-September) of the fiscal year.

- The request should be based on the District's short-term cash flow plan when requesting funds from MINECOFIN and;
- When requesting funds from LODA, the District must submit the following documents:
 - ✓ A request letter from the District.
 - ✓ A report from MEIS detailing the fund request.
 - ✓ The list of beneficiaries.
 - ✓ The payroll list from MEIS showing the ID and amount for each beneficiary.

Note: All these documents must be uploaded to the MEIS system and send the request letter and report from MEIS to info@loda.gov.rw.

1.2.7. Training / awareness campaign

To ensure that the implementation of the old age grant for the elderly in need (from low-income families) is well understood and executed according to these guidelines, training and awareness campaigns will be conducted for the following groups:

Training Recipients:

- Local government officials
- Para-social workers

Awareness Campaign Recipients:

- Grant recipients
- The general public

1.2.8. Grievances, appeals, and procedures

- If a household receiving regular direct support has an elderly person but they are not listed for the old age grant, they can appeal to the Sector level. If unsatisfied with the Sector's decision, the issue can be escalated to the District through the Vice Mayor in charge of social welfare. Once the appeal is approved, an "Appeal Document" is filled, and the information is corrected in the designated system.
- If the household is not satisfied with the District's decision on their appeal, they can escalate the issue to MINALOC or LODA, which will review the issue in detail and communicate the final decision to the District and Sector.
- Appeals can also be submitted electronically via a designated system where citizens can use their phone or computer to send a message to LODA. After reviewing the appeal, LODA will respond based on the findings.

2. Expanded Public Works - Labor Based

2.1. Principles of ePW

Expanded public works (ePW) scheme have two main principles that provide a year-round wages and flexible working hours.

- **Wages:** Recipients receive a monthly wage of 15,000 Rwf for all 12 months of the year.
- **Working hours:** Working hours should be flexible. Project outputs should be achievable based on an equivalent of 12 hours' work per week.

2.2. Selection of Workers and Supervisors for Expanded Public Works

2.2.1. Eligibility criteria

- Households living in extreme poverty / poverty with no assets (lands, livestock, forest, ...) or the income from those assets is not sufficient to allow the members of households to satisfy their basic needs,
- Residing in a sector for at least 6 months.

2.2.2. Targeting Process

- (a) The provisional targeting list (PTL) of ePW recipients is generated from the dynamic social registry and compare it with the previous financial year list of recipients;
- (b) Districts and sectors, using the community meeting/ consultation, select the eligible households and adjust the list of eligible households which will be approved by the sector council. Once is approved, the list is entered into the system used to monitor the implementation of this scheme;
- (c) Depending on the availability of resources, the eligible households fulfilling the following conditions will be prioritized as follows:

Priority 1: Household with only one member able to work ($18 \leq x < 65$ years) and at least one child aged from **0 to 5 years**;

Priority 2: Household with only one member able to work and has a moderate disability (disability category **3 & 4**);

Priority 3: Household with only one member able to work and at least one child aged from **6 to 14 years**;

Priority 4: Household made of one member who is female and able to work;

Priority 5: Household with only one member able to work and the worker is aged from **60 to 64 years**;

Priority 6: Household made of two members able to work and both aged from **60 to 64 years**

2.2.3. Selection of Workers (recipients)

A Cell General Assembly meeting should be convened to Identify all eligible households in the cell (per the Provisional Targeting List generated from the Social Registry, review eligible households with people with disability who are not yet medically classified first reviewed and approved by sector disability council level for disability assessment and collect any missing National ID data and bank/SACCO account details for nominated households

2.2.4. Sector Council to approve the final eligible list

Selected households should be presented for approval to the Sector Council by the Sector. Once sector council has approved the eligible list, the Sector should be authorised to enter the data into MEIS.

2.2.5. Finalisation of targeting list

The Sector will convene a meeting at sector level for all households selected to participate in the ePW Labor Based project. The purpose of this meeting is to:

- a) Nominate the ePW workers, elect the group representatives, select the cell supervisors.
- b) Resolve any discrepancies between project worker requirements, cell quotas and numbers of households selected;
- c) Inform participants of their roles and responsibilities;
- d) Collect any participants' Bank/SACCO account numbers/ MNOs or National ID numbers which were not available during the Cell General Assembly meeting;
- e) From among the eligible households, identify groups that live close to the proposed work sites;
- f) Allocate households to ePW projects including Service based and labor based. The process for doing this is likely to vary by location but could operate as follows:

Step 1: Identify all priority households for ePW C/HBECD

Step 2: Enroll all remaining priority households for ePW labor based

Step 3: Allocate ePW-eligible HHs (up to the maximum quota size for the sector) to each Labor Based project (10-15 per group depending on proximity to the worksite). Identify group representatives for each Labor based group.

e) The Sector Management Team will approve the final list of workers and cell supervisors. Households may be enrolled in both ePW LB and ePW H/CBECD projects within the sector in case of insufficient number of participants to deliver to staff the project.

2.2.6. Preparation and signing of contracts

The Sector Technical lead (Land/Infrastructure Officer for LB projects), should prepare contracts for signature by the District/Sector Executive Secretary.

The workers' contracts will be for **flexible employment**. No more than 12 hours work per week (equivalent of 2 hours work per day for 6 days per week⁵);

The workers contract for ePW Flexible Road Maintenance projects will follow the format provided in **Annex 4**. Contracts for all ePW projects should be accompanied by:

- a) List of final eligible list approved by the Sector Council;
- b) Wage rate and payment terms as defined in these guidelines

2.2.7. Selection and contracting of ePW Cell Supervisors

ePW Cell Supervisors shall be nominated preferably from among the ePW-eligible households.

ePW Cell Supervisors should have the following qualifications at the minimum:

- Able to read and write (at least completion of Primary education);
- Of good character, honest, able to organise work groups.

Cell supervisors for y

Flexible road maintenance (FRM) projects should be contracted using the contract template provided in **Annex 6**.

2.2.8. Removing a HH from an Expanded Public Works Labor Based project:

A household may only be removed from a VUP Expanded Public Works Labor Based project if:

- a) The household moves to a different sector; or
- b) The household's worker dies or permanently moves out of the household (in such cases the household should be enrolled in VUP Direct Support);
- c) A household does not send an appropriate member to attend ePW activities for a period of at least one month without providing an appropriate justification (e.g. temporary sickness).
- d) A household loses equipment provided to them and refuses to replace it.

The Removal of an ePW household should be initiated by a Group Representative (LB) or Site Supervisor. Documentation of justification for removal and nomination of replacements shall be conducted using the '**ePW Household Removal and Replacement Form**' (**Annex 5**).

Once the Sector Executive Secretary has approved the form, it should be submitted to the district for data entry into MEIS. In the event that a household is removed from a VUP Expanded Public Works Labor Based project, the Village General Assembly shall nominate a replacement for approval by the Sector Management Team. The Sector shall then submit the form to the district for data entry.

2.3. Procurement

Expanded Public Works projects require that procurement of the following items be conducted as per government procurement regulations and procedures:

- a) **ePW Labor Based project workers:** Participant households should be contracted as groups using the 'Community Procurement' method (according to procurement regulations) (**see Annex 6 ePW Group Representative Contract Template**).
- b) **ePW Labor Based project supervisors:** District implementing ePW Labor Based project should normally contract a Cell level ePW supervisors.
- c) **Materials and equipment:** The project simplified feasibility study (SFA) will identify what tools and equipment will be needed for each type of project. Typically, equipment will be

⁵ Workers should not be required to work every day nor to keep a timesheet

bought every three years for an ongoing project, unless the project feasibility study states otherwise.

All Procurement shall be conducted by the district following the Rwanda procurement regulations. In order to ensure timely implementation of ePW Labor Based projects, procurement should commence immediately at the start of the new financial year. Districts should not wait for funds to be disbursed before commencing procurement.

2.4. Funds requests

Districts will request funds early in the financial year so that (i) on-going projects can be finished in a timely way and (ii) new projects can be mobilised early. This may be done prior to the start of the financial year. Districts shall request funds from MINECOFIN according to the standard procedures. However, funds disbursed by LODA shall be disbursed in two tranches as follows:

	Disbursement value	Disbursement triggers
Tranche 1:	100% of project non-wage procurement contract value <i>plus</i> 50% of wages budget	ePW recipients selected and approved by Sector Council
Tranche 2:	Remaining of wages budget	Expenditure of minimum of 70% of tranche 1 funds (progress report to be attached)

N.B: In the event that procurement of materials/equipment is delayed, districts may request the funds for wages and then request funds for equipment separately once procurement has been finalised. This is intended to allow timely initiation of ePW Labor Based projects.

Districts shall submit supporting documentation during funds request as set out in **Box 6:**

Box 6. Supporting documentation for ePW funds requests	
Year 1	
First installment - Letter of request by the district - Transfer Request Report generated from MEIS - Copy of simplified Feasibility Assessment - Sector Council meeting minutes approving recipient list - Contracts for Cell Supervisors	Final instalment - Letter of request by the district - Transfer Request Report generated from MEIS - Progress report - Financial report (Payment voucher attached)
Year 2 onwards	
First installment - Letter of request by the District Transfer - Request Report generated from MEIS - Copy of Contracts for Cell Supervisors - Progress report (Previous financial year annual report)	Final instalment - Letter of request by the district - Transfer Request Report generated from MEIS - Progress report of activities - Financial report (payment voucher) - Contract for supply of ePW LB equipment

N.B: The following documents should be uploaded into MEIS and serve as supporting documents for ePW funds requests:

A. Tenders awarded to the community

- A note of the meeting at which the recipients select the group representatives and supervisors
- Copy of Contracts for group representatives
- Copy of simplified Feasibility Assessment

B. For contracts related to supply of materials

- Copy of the invitation to tender that put in a news paper
- Copy of tender document
- Copy of the bidding document of the successful bidder
- Copy of the evaluation report by the internal tender committee
- Copy of the final notification letter

2.5. Expanded Public Works project implementation

2.5.1. Overall implementation principles for ePW

- Expanded Public Works Labor Based projects shall be implemented in compliance with technical norms and standards issued by relevant technical authorities
- Care should be taken to ensure that PwDs are allocated to appropriate ePW LB job types.
- ePW recipients shall also participate in monthly sensitisation activities organised by the District/ Sector or partners;
- Work should start immediately after contracts have been signed;
- Under no circumstances shall children under the age of 18 years participate or work in Expanded Public Works Labor Based;
- Appropriate and reasonable measures shall be taken to protect the health and safety of expanded public works Labor Based participants. Participants will be encouraged to act appropriately and responsibly.
- The following essential tools and equipment (Spade; Hoe; Panga; Slasher; Boots⁶; High visibility jacket; Wheelbarrows and pickaxes⁷) for use on ePW labor-based projects will be purchased from the VUP budget and issued to each participating household and group at the start of project implementation. If equipment is lost, stolen or broken, participants will be responsible for the purchase of replacements. After three years' new equipment will be bought by the district.

2.5.2. Training of ePW workers and Cell Supervisors

Prior to the start of Expanded Public Works Labor Based projects, workers and Cell Supervisors shall be receiving on-the-job training on the relevant technical, health and safety guidelines and norms and standards from the Sector Infrastructure Officer, Sector Land Officer or District Engineer (for LB).

2.5.3. The role of Group Representatives in ePW LB project implementation

Group representatives shall be responsible for:

- i. Monitoring fair distribution of work among group members;
- ii. Ensuring compliance with relevant technical standards on a day-to-day basis
- iii. Communicating with Site Supervisors and Sector staff on behalf of group members;
- iv. Initiating member replacement procedures, if necessary, through the Site Supervisor.

2.6. Payment principles and procedures

- Expanded Public Works Labor Based participant households will be paid a flat monthly wage of RWF 15,000 plus bank charges every month throughout the year;

⁶ The Social Affairs Officer will ask the recipients for their size for boots

⁷ Wheelbarrows and pickaxes will also be provided to groups – one per five recipients

- Payments will be made on a monthly basis, within the first 15 days of the following month;
- All Expanded Public Works Labor Based participants be paid the same rate, irrespective of the type of employment;
- Participants will NOT be required to keep a timesheet but payments will cease if work is reported to be unsatisfactory;
- No deductions shall be made from VUP cPW payments during the payment process, except on recipient order supported by a signed individual consent
- In the event of delays of the annual validation of the targeting list, validated households shall receive payments based on the date the Sector Council approved the targeting lists except those who will be removed from the previous list and should be paid for the number months worked. **Note that if sector council approves the list in 15 days of the month, only the approved list will be paid.**

2.7. Supervision arrangements

Where the LB projects are being implemented, a cell Supervisor shall be nominated among ePW as first priority and cPW where there is no qualifying supervisor from ePW caseloads, woman should be prioritised in each Cell to supervise project implementation and ensure compliance with technical, health and safety norms and standards.

The Cell Administration will also conduct spot checks and raise any concerns with the Group Representatives or cell Supervisor as necessary.

In addition, Sector Infrastructure and Land Notary Officer shall also be assigned by the Sector administration to conduct regular monitoring visits to the project sites to validate the reports submitted by the cell Supervisors and support trouble-shooting (including addressing challenges that fall outside of the scope of work of ePW Labor Based project – such as a landslide affecting a Flexible Road Maintenance project.

Finally, officials from the District One-Stop Center and Social Development Units should conduct regular spot-checks on ePW projects as part of their on-going monitoring and evaluation regime. Specific attention should be paid to ensuring compliance with environmental and social safeguarding procedures.

2.8. Reporting requirements

- ePW Cell Supervisors will report on a **monthly basis** to the Sector, **through the Cell administration** covering technical progress, status of work groups and payment status
- The Sector ES will then: take any remedial action necessary and compile a monthly report of all Expanded Public Works projects and send to the District Executive Secretary
- The district will then: Take the necessary action, integrate ePW project reporting into the quarterly PW reporting format for LODA and MINALOC (copied to the province). The same report shall be reported by Districts through MEIS on regular basis.

3. ePW-C/HBECD Implementation Guidelines

3.1. Introduction

This section of the document provides detailed guidelines on the planning, implementation and reporting of the VUP ePW Home/Community Based Early Child Development (H/CB-ECD) scheme.

The objectives of Expanded Public Works Home/Community-Based Early Childhood Development are:

- a) To provide multi-year, year-round, accessible and flexible employment for extremely poor households with caring responsibilities. Household with person:
 - i. who is a woman able to work but pregnant;
 - ii. able to work but having disability (cat 3 & 4 or approved by the community) or illness preventing him/her to work many hours a day;
 - iii. able to work but constrained by the age between 60 to 64
- b) To provide inclusive, safe and stimulating community/ Home Based ECD for children aged 2 to 5 years whilst their parents work.
- c) Capacity development of caregivers on quality and integrated ECD services delivery for holistic child development and welfare in community of ePW project

3.2. Eligibility criteria and priorities

The Households that are eligible for Home Based ECDs are selected from the eligible list of ePW recipients starting by the caregivers who received previously training on ECD services delivery, but following the criteria below depending on the resources availability:

- **Priority 1:** Household with only one member able to work and at least one child aged **between 0 and 5 years;**
- **Priority 2:** Household with only one member able to work, who is disabled but can still work (**disability category 3 & 4**);
- **Priority 3:** Households with only one member able to work and at least one child aged **between 6 and 14 years;**
- **Priority 4:** Household made of only one member who is female;
- **Priority 5:** Households with only one member able to work and aged **between 60 and 64 years;**
- **Priority 6:** Households made of only two members able to work and aged **between 60 and 64 years;**
- **Priority 7:** Teen mothers impregnated early but have **16 years old today if she is not at school as they are first encouraged to return to school;**

Note: Under no circumstances shall children under the age of 16 years (teen/young girls) be allowed to work in C/HB ECD.

3.3. Selection of ePW C/HBECD participants

3.3.1. Selection of Caregivers

On average, each H/CBECD project should employ 1 lead care-giver who sign contract (see annex 21) on behalf of other additional 6 assistant care-givers (ePW recipients). H/CBECD are expected to provide care for approximately 10-15 children. This is in line with the ECD minimum standards of the teacher child ratio between the age ranges of 2-5 years old.

There are expected to be between 10-20 C/HB ECDs per sector, although the exact number will depend on the number of ePW recipients in each sector.

3.3.2. Responsibilities of caregivers

Caregivers will be responsible for:

- Ensuring a safe environment and providing stimulating care for the children. Caregivers will develop a weekly schedule that will include educational activities and games, singing and supervised play.
- Preparing daily porridge or food for the children in accordance with nutrition guidelines and provide safe drinking water, supervising toileting and ensuring that the latrine and general environment is kept clean and safe at all times.
- Facilitating the weekly distribution of FBF to primary care givers (parents/guardians) of children below 3 years of age.
- Facilitating referrals of sick children to nearby health facilities or community health workers (CHW).
- Facilitating referrals and follow-up of children suffering abuse to the Inshuti z'umuryango (IZU).
- Facilitating monthly visits by CHW for the screening of children and Parenting education in health aspects (nutrition, cooking demonstrations, family planning, vaccination...) in collaboration with IZU and CHW and other ECD partners.
- Facilitating referrals of services for children with disabilities and special needs in collaboration with the IZU and CHW.
- Facilitating the setting up of the kitchen garden for the home based ECD nutrition services and cooking demonstration and monitor its maintenance.
- Facilitating referrals through the para social workers for eligible social protection recipients to the Cell Social and development (SEDO)/ Human Capital Development officer.
- Collaborate with the cell SEDO on administrative and management issues, and refer any more difficult technical issues to the Sector Supervisor.
- Mobilise Parents to enrol their children in ECD Settings

3.3.3. Selection of lead caregivers

The Lead Caregivers shall be selected among the caregivers preferably the owner of the C/HBECD facility and should fulfil at least the following requirements:

- Able to read and write
- Of good conduct, honest, able to organise and supervise work at C/HBECD facility.

On behalf of the group of caregivers, lead caregivers should sign a contract with District/ Sector.

3.3.4. Days and Hours of Operation of the C/HBECD and Required Facilities

- Home-based care will operate all year round up to 6 days per week and for approximately 5 to 6 hours per day.
- The precise hours of operation will be agreed collectively by the C/HB ECD care givers and sector supervisor in order to cover the working hours of parents, with particular attention given to covering the working hours of parents reliant on agricultural wage work.
- ePW H/CBECD Facilities will provide care for children between 2 to 5 years. Community/ Home Based ECD is not suitable for children younger than 24 months due to their significant care needs and the need for the youngest children to remain close to mothers for breastfeeding. At the age of 5 where a pre-primary class are available, they should be encouraged to attend and at age of 6 years' children must enroll in the local primary school.
- Each C/HBECD Facility will cover one or two villages, depending on the number of eligible and interested households. First priority will be given to children from households' recipients of VUP. If there are any remaining spaces, other children in proximity will be enrolled in the

center. When a child leaves to go to pre-primary or primary school the caregivers will seek a replacement. The same entry criteria will be followed.

- The percentage of poor households should be regularly monitored, and in every C/HB ECD facility at least 50% of the children should be from poor households.

3.4. HB-ECD Setting

- Children will be cared for close to their own homes in either a home of one of the parents or in an available community/ public building.
- The home owner is by principle a **lead caregiver, unless he/she has other attributions which conflict with that responsibility.**
- Parents might also decide to construct a purpose-built centre, using their own resources or with the support of local authorities or another partner. Although, the funds may not be used for construction of a C/HBECD site, minor refurbishments of existing facilities may be financed under this arrangement. This may include the light construction or renovation of a latrine where necessary.
- If a chosen site is a home, the owner should be prioritised and encouraged to provide care in their home for a period of at least three years. However, the duration of hosting this chosen site should not be an imposition on the home owner. If, in exceptional circumstances, it proves necessary for the group to move before the end of the three-year period, all equipment provided to the group must be moved also, the home owner should sign a consent form
- If the home/community facility does not meet the above requirements, it must be upgraded. In this case: Sector should contract with the home owner and perform the refurbishment activities, the funds dedicated to these activities are determined and prioritised by the sector and should not exceed **RWF 250,000**. If it requires more, the site should be rejected and replaced by another home. The opinion leaders are preferred if they agreed to host the C/HBECD.

The contract (Annex 8) related to the refurbishment activities must be signed between the sector and the contractor (preferably the owner of the home/facility), this should use community procurement approach method as described in Rwanda procurement law.

- Children should be collected by their parents or designated care giver/guardian and must not be allowed to walk home alone.
- H/CBECD facilities must provide:
 - i. A latrine that is safe and accessible for children to use and always kept clean
 - ii. Hand washing facilities with soap and water accessible to children
 - iii. Safe drinking water (Boiled or with Sur'eau) in clean water container.
 - iv. A nutritious meal or porridge provided every day for the children in accordance with nutrition guidelines
 - v. Kitchen or an area for cooking and boiling water that is NOT accessible to children
 - vi. Mat, Safe and age-appropriate play and learning equipment
 - vii. Outside play area must be fenced and safe. Where there is no existing fence or shelter for an outside play area, parents of participating children should contribute labour and local materials to construct one (construct fences with a lockable gate at houses that host ePW C/HBECDs where possible).

- Gas cylinders must be kept in the room separate from the teaching and learning room in case the ePW C/HBECDs use the gas for cooking.

3.5. Organisation of Work within a C/HBECD

- To ensure safety of children, there **MUST** always be at least two caregivers present.
- Care-givers will work an average of 12 hours per week in shifts, ensuring that the group is open 5-6 days per week for 5-6 hours per day.
- The Lead Caregiver will be responsible for managing the project site and will be required to be present everyday, at least at the start and end of the day. He/She will arrange a work rotation/schedule with the assistant care-givers. Carers can either work for 2 hours per day (as in Example Rotation A below) or arrange an alternative schedule such as demonstrated in Example Rota B below.

Number of hours work per day															
Rotation A	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	Rotation B	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
Lead care giver	2	2	2	2	2	2		Lead Care giver	2	2	2	2	2	2	
Carer 1	2	2	2	2	2	2		Carer 1	6	6					
Carer 2	2	2	2	2	2	2		Carer 2	6	6					
Carer 3	2	2	2	2	2	2		Carer 3			6	6			
Carer 4	2	2	2	2	2	2		Carer 4			6	6			
Carer 5	2	2	2	2	2	2		Carer 5					6	6	
Carer 6	2	2	2	2	2	2		Carer 6					6	6	

- In case they cannot reach agreement, the issue will be raised with the lead care giver and SEDO for resolution.
- The Lead care-giver will also keep a record of attendance by each caregiver and a Child Personal file. However, the purpose of these attendance records is to support the functioning of the group and submission of these records will not be a condition of payment.

3.6. Start-up equipment and inputs in C/HBECD

Once identified, a quick assessment shall be conducted to ascertain which of those sites meet the H/CBCC minimum standards. In particular, where no home can be found with a suitable latrine or kitchen, minor refurbishments to the selected homes and community facilities shall be catered for. Construction is only limited to latrines.

The Sector Supervisor, lead caregiver and SEDO will be responsible for submitting requests for financing of refurbishment to the Sector.

The Sector Officials will review all such requests, together with relevant technical specialists at sector level, and Sector Executive Secretary will forward approved requests to the District Executive Secretary, who will be responsible for final approval, ensuring that expenditure on refurbishment does not exceed 1 million FRW per 3 years per Cell.

3.6.1. Essential equipment

The following essential equipment will also be purchased from the VUP budget and issued to each group at the start of the home/community-based ECD project. The equipment is expected to last three years. If the group is still in existence after 3 years, a replacement set of equipment will be provided if need be. However, during the course of implementation, the group should

replace any lost or damaged items and will be encouraged to make small regular contributions for this purpose.

- Tippy tap for handwashing
- Materials for making local toys and Crayons
- 8 sleeping mats (1 shared by two children)
- 15 plastic cups
- 3 saucepans (1 for boiling water, 1 for porridge and 1 food if applicable)
- 2 jugs for storing drinking water
- 3 buckets and 3 basins
- 2 Jerry cans/ 1 Small water tank and Feeding spoons (20)
- Tarpaulin for rain-proofing the local structure that covers the outside play area
- Notebooks and pens and Register for daily records
- An initial supply of soap, toilet paper, Matches, Paper for drawing.
- Caregivers' Manual and parenting guides

3.6.2. Ongoing Supplies

The porridge will be procured by District annually and supplier will proceed with distribution based on sector demand. The budget required will be calculated based on the number of expected children to be registered in C/HB ECD and during budgeting process 100FRW per child per day will be allocated to C/HBECD budget line to cover the cost of a nutritious porridge. In-kind contributions from parents will be required to cover toilet paper, firewood/charcoal, matches and drawing paper. LODA/NCDA will liaise with MINEDUC and other actors to ensure C/HB-ECD feeding or porridge provision aligns with school feeding guidelines/standards, where feasible and affordable.

3.6.3. Porridge minimum standards

The porridge flours to be supplied to H/CBECDs should be absolutely made with a mixture of at least two cereals together with Soya grains. In addition, the porridge flour should be of better quality, well prepared and stored, without any sandstone or other dirt.

3.7. ePW C/HBECD wage payment principles and procedures

- Expanded Public Works Service Based participant households (caregivers) will be paid a flat monthly wage of RWF 15,000 per month plus bank charges;
- The lead caregivers will be paid a flat monthly wage of RWF 20,000 plus bank charges
- The sector supervisors will be paid a monthly net wage of RFW 70,000 including Frw 10,000 for communication fees;
- Payments will be made on a monthly basis, within the first 15 days of the following month;
- Caregivers will NOT be required to keep a timesheet but payments will cease if work is reported to be unsatisfactory;
- No deductions shall be made from VUP cPW payments during the payment process, except on recipient order supported by a signed individual consent
- In the event of delays of the annual validation of the targeting list, validated households shall receive payments based on the date the Sector Council approved the targeting lists except those who will be removed from the previous list and should be paid for the number months worked. Note that if sector council approve the list in 15 days of the month, only the approved list will be paid.

3.8. Supervision Arrangements

3.8.1. Sector Supervisors/Trainers

The **ePW Sector Supervisor** will build capacity in ECD and provide technical oversight of home/community-based ECDs in assigned sector. This will be full-time activity. It would be most suitable for someone with previous ECD experience, trained on ECD Program, though university graduates without experience, but with a strong interest in this area of work will also be considered.

The main responsibilities of contracted Sector Supervisor (**see annex 3**) will be to:

- a) Train all caregivers involved in ECD Settings will be conducted annually for 5 days on module such as the caregivers' guide and others that maybe suggested by service provider. A refresher training can be delivered after two years of experience for updating caregivers on new changes
- b) Share lessons learnt with Sector Social Protection Officers, Education officer and Health and Sanitation officer
- c) Attend Sector management meetings on regular basis to provide update, challenges and lesson learnt related to C/HECD
- d) Monitor and report on C/HBECD settings in the sector on monthly basis and on sample basis conduct a field visit of at least 6 C/HBECD per month and produce monthly report in line with ECD services monthly reporting format shared by LODA⁸ and quarterly reports that reflect on key achievements, lessons learned and recommendations for improvements, Sector Supervisor should use the checklist provided at **Annex 7** to monitor quality of provision.
- e) Participate in one parenting sessions in different villages every month (covering all villages at least twice per year) to monitor and oversee them and to provide feedback to SEDO and Lead caregiver who will implement them.
- f) Ensure maintenance of quality integrated ECD services implementation.
- g) Meet at least monthly with parents who are not caregivers to get their views on the operation of the groups and the quality of work of the caregivers.
- h) Train, Coach Village leaders and Mutwarasibo (Head of Isibo) on the Provision and supervision of integrated ECD services in the Village
- i) Mobilise Parents to enrol their children in ECD Settings
- j) **Monitor and follow up parenting education sessions** and participate at least in 2 sessions in 2 different cells that have home/community-based ECD facility. Parenting education will be provided to members of the childcare group, and open to all parents in the village with children aged 0 to 5 years and pregnant women. The timing of these sessions will be agreed between participants, but late afternoons are likely to be preferred by working parents. Sessions may be held at or around the ECD facility, or at any other convenient site in the village. They will cover a wide range of topics essential to the development of the young child, including:
 - young child and maternal nutrition (with a focus on the first 1,000 days)
 - young child and maternal health and care
 - hygiene and sanitation and waste management

⁸ LODA will harmonise its report format with the one shared by NCDA

- promoting children's physical and cognitive development through play (including practical learning on making toys from local materials, and demonstration of games and songs)
- promoting children's emotional development
- protecting children from violence, abuse and neglect and positive discipline
- positive parenting, early brain stimulation and responsive care
- Early developmental delay and Disability Detection and referral for services provision
- supporting children with disabilities or special needs
- Addressing GBV and equality within the family
- Initiation of Income Generating Activities
- Saving culture and loan management

The Sector Supervisor should also solicit participation in these sessions from CHWs to lead nutrition/health/hygiene and IZUs to lead child protection sessions and Nurses or Nutritionist, Social workers and Community health officers from the nearest Health facility or use any other local professional in a such domain.

- k) **Notify the Sector Social Protection Officer** of any changes in group composition or hours of operation.
- l) **Attend monthly meetings** with caregivers and sector officials, trainers (Sector social Affairs officer and sector education Officer) and sector officials at sector level for monitoring and lesson learning and submit brief monthly reports to sector.

3.8.2. Selection criteria

The minimum selection criteria for the Sector Supervisors should be that they have:

- At least secondary education, ideally higher education, value additional: ECD and TTC
- Residence in the sector or willingness to re-locate there

Selected candidates should have demonstrated an interest in early childhood development through: previous paid or voluntary work related to childcare or child development; or relevant studies (such as in nutrition, education, health or social work); or experience of childcare within a family setting.

3.8.3. Roles and Responsibilities

3.8.3.1. Recipients responsibilities

Parents who are members of C/HBECD facility will:

- Bring their children regularly to the ECD setting and notify caregivers if their child is going to be absent
- Not bring to ECD setting a child who does not feel well/sick so as to avoid/prevent spread of infection
- Notify the lead caregiver should they wish to leave the group
- Providing in-kind contributions like toilet paper, firewood/charcoal, matches

All ePW Care-Givers will:

- Provide high quality care to the children in their care, in line with the training received, and complete all tasks to the best of their ability
- Attend for work regularly and ensure that there are always two caregivers present on every working day
- Have collective responsibility for ensuring that the C/HBECD group operates regularly and for notifying the lead caregiver of any problems

- Agree in whose home the childcare will be provided
- Participate in group meetings for ongoing decision-making
- Complete registers of children's attendance
- Take good care of the equipment provided
- Help organise and participate in monthly parenting sessions in health aspects (nutrition, cooking demonstrations, family planning, vaccination...) in collaboration with IZU and CHW and other ECD partners

The Lead Care-Givers will:

- Organise and chair regular meetings of the C/HBECD facility
- Receive and Manage purchased food and other material provided to C/HBECD
- In collaboration with CHW and under guidance of SEDO and Sector supervisor, lead parenting education sessions every month with parents within a village
- Notify SEDO and Sector supervisor of any challenges in the facility, any changes in facility composition, or any changes in its hours of operation
- Be the key contact point with the Sector Supervisor and SEDO
- Manage the work rotation system and keep records of days worked by each caregiver
- Facilitating the weekly distribution of FBF (if any) to primary care givers (parents/guardians) of children below 3 years of age.
- Facilitating monthly visits by CHW for the screening of children.
- Facilitating referrals of sick children to nearby health facilities or community health workers (CHW).
- Facilitating referrals and follow-up of children suffering abuse to the Inshuti z'umuryango (IZU)
- Facilitating referrals to service providers of services for children with disabilities and special needs in collaboration with the IZU and CHW
- Facilitating the setting up of the kitchen garden for the C/HBECD nutrition services and cooking demonstration and monitor its maintenance.
- Notify the Sector Supervisor of any changes in group composition or hours of operation.
- Facilitating referrals through the para social workers for eligible social protection recipients to the Cell Social and development (SEDO)/ Human Capital Development officer.
- Collaborate with the cell SEDO on administrative and management issues, and refer any more difficult technical issues to the Sector Supervisor.
- Mobilise Parents to enroll their children in ECD Settings

3.8.3.2. Roles and responsibilities of Central Government (CG) and LG

Institution	Role and Responsibilities
NCDA	i. Ensuring increased quality infrastructure of ECD facilities, equitably and geographically distributed; ii. Developing ECD caregivers' incentives framework and capacity building plan; iii. Availing a full package of learning, play materials, and equipment in ECD settings to ensure quality, integrated ECD services to all children including children with disabilities; iv. Ensuring ECD standards are developed, reviewed, and disseminated to all ECD service providers; v. Establishing a dynamic ECD database/ information system, including ECD facilities by types and location, ECD service providers and their services, caregivers' profiles, etc

Institution	Role and Responsibilities
	vi. Developing a strategy to sustainably support feeding programs in ECD facilities and prioritize diversified nutritious foods; vii. Conducting monitoring and evaluation of the quality of ECD service provision and the ECD minimum standards in general;
REB	i. Support ECD caregiver's/teachers' capacity building and salaries ii. Support in the supply of teaching, learning, play materials, and equipment in ECD settings to ensure quality, integrated ECD services to all children iii. Conducting monitoring and evaluation of the quality of ECD service provision and the ECD standards in general; iv. Support in adaptation of ECD training materials, learning and teaching materials in alignment with the curriculum and ECD policy;
LODA	i. Define the ePW H/CBCC geographical targeting and scale-up plan on an annual basis; ii. Produce the provisional targeting lists from MEIS/SRIS; iii. Lead the procurement of the service provider to build capacity at local level, with a specific focus on training on integrated ECD service provision; iv. Ensure that ePW H/CBCC is appropriately integrated into District Plans and Budgets; v. Lead the development of implementation guidelines relating to household targeting, wage setting and payments procedures; vi. In collaboration with NECDP, train Local Governments on ePW design and implementation modalities; vii. Oversee ePW H/CBCC participant targeting process; viii. Transfer funds for ePW to districts in a timely manner; ix. Monitor the timely delivery of payments to ePW H/CBCC participants. x. Participate in resource mobilisation; xi. Ensure that the LODA MEIS caters for critical business processes and monitoring of the ePW H/CBCC scheme and ensure that local government staffs are able to use the system.
Districts	Through Social Development and Health Units staff, Nursery Primary and Adult Literacy Officer, Gender and family Officer, Nutritionist, disability officer, /ECD Focal Person and Child Protection and Welfare Officer (CPWO), District will: i. Coordination and monitoring of the implementation of ECD services within district; ii. Liaise with potential stakeholders for the ECDs. iii. Select carers to work on ePW H/CBECD projects in line with targeting guidelines issued by LODA iv. Mobilize households to send their children between 2 to 6 years of age to ePW H/CBECD groups as per guidelines issued by LODA v. Work with NCDA and LODA to identify ePW H/CBECD facilities vi. Recruit and manage ePW supervisors as per guidelines issued by LODA vii. Procure materials and rehabilitation of community facilities as per guidance issued by LODA and NCDA viii. Undertake periodic visits to ePW C/HB ECD settings for monitoring and learning on a quarterly basis and elaborate and submit quarterly report at LODA ix. Participate in parenting session organized at Sector, Cell or village level x. Ensure that targets for ePW including C/HBECD are included into District planning documents xi. Ensure that every fiscal year the budget for ePW including HBECD is available xii. Report ePW H/CBECDs data on monthly basis
Sector	Sector Executive Secretary will have the following responsibilities: i. Contract ePW Sector Supervisor for H/CBECD (in collaboration with the Sector Social Protection Officer) ii. Select Sector Supervisors (in collaboration with SPO) iii. Participate in parenting session organized at village or sector level The Sector Social Protection Officer will: i. Manage selection of caregivers and establishment of groups ii. Review quarterly reports submitted by the sector Supervisor

Institution	Role and Responsibilities
	iii. Skill themselves on ECD and childcare issues by engaging actively with the Sector Supervisor iv. Conduct at least quarterly visits to an ePW C/HBECD setting v. Participate in parenting session organized at sector or village level vi. Monitor timeliness of payments vii. Document and escalate any complaints to the District as necessary viii. Report ePW H/CBECDs data on monthly basis
Cell	The Cell Executive Secretary and the Socio-Economic Development Officer will: i. Organize a monthly meeting with caregivers at cell level ii. In collaboration with sector supervisor, organize and monitor the parenting education session on monthly basis iii. Follow, monitoring and participate (on sample basis) parenting education sessions iv. Support selection of caregivers and establishment of groups v. Monitoring and follow up of implementation of Home Based ECD vi. Follow up and implementation of recommendations provided by Sector staff including sector supervisor in order to improve the services provided at HBECD center; vii. Document and escalate any complaints from recipients to the Sector as necessary; viii. Report ePW H/CBECDs data on monthly basis;
Health posts and health centres	i. Provide health care to children attending the ECD centres if needed; ii. Participate in parenting education session and behaviour Change of communities;
Stakeholders / actors in C/HBECD	i. Support established ECD or assist the community to establish ECD centres; ii. Support the behaviour change of communities.

4. Nutrition Sensitive Direct Support scheme

4.1. Introduction

The Government of Rwanda through Ministry of Local Government and Local Administrative Entities Development Agency (LODA) which has been an umbrella for social protection programs in Rwanda (GoR), decided to act proactively by investing in the early years of a child's life with the broader objective to contribute to the eradication of malnutrition (SP plan 2018-2024) hence contribute to human capital development. In the same framework, the GoR through LODA with support from different partners' implements Nutrition Sensitive Direct Support (NSDS) under VUP program. Originally established as a flagship programme within the first Economic Development and Poverty Reduction Strategy (EDPRS), the VUP remains key to the delivery of a range of national targets under EDPRS2 (2013-2018) and realisation of Vision 2050.

NSDS has the following **two main objectives**:

- To provide income support to poor and vulnerable pregnant women, new mothers and young children, allowing for adequate consumption and improved diet; and
- To incentivize uptake of key health and nutrition services and behavioural change.

Specific objectives

- Prevent and eliminate stunting and malnutrition among under five children by providing support to poor households allowing them to access on improved diet and appropriate use of key health and nutrition services;
- Prevent malnutrition and/or stunting associated with lack of hygiene and sanitation by facilitating and incentivizing good practices among recipients; Encourage/incentivize recipients (pregnant mothers, mother's wit under two children and caregivers) for uptake of key health

and nutrition services provided by health centers and community health workers (Family planning included);

4.2. Target group and eligibility criteria

4.2.1. Target groups

All pregnant woman or a child aged 0-24 months from Households living in extreme poverty/ poverty with no assests (lands, livestock, forest, ...) or the available income from those assets is not sufficient to allow households access on the basic needs and/ or practices adequate nutrition of child in the 1000 days of life, shall be eligible for the NSDS cash transfers.

4.2.2. Eligibility criteria:

- Pregnant women and children aged 0-24 months living in poor households determined as socially vulnerable according to the relevant socio-economic and welfare criteria (limited assets or other source of income to sustain their livelihoods), who are permanent residents of the targeted sector.

Note1: Households benefitting from other social protection and nutrition interventions shall remain eligible for the NSDS transfers.

Note2: A child not registered in the NSDS scheme within 18 months of birth shall not qualify.

4.2.3. Registration mechanism

At community level, community members are informed about the core objectives of the NSDS by community health workers, parasocial workers and local authorities (cell executive secretary, and SEDOs);

- Eligible Recipients will be identified by local governments on an on-going basis in partnership with health centers;
- Eligible pregnant women should be identified early on in pregnancy and payments will continue until their child's second birthday;
- Eligible pregnant women and/or mothers /guardians will be encouraged to attend their local health center for routine ANC, PNC and nutrition services use;
- After the use of maternal/or child health services (ANC, PNC, growth monitoring services), detailed health data together with ID number of the pregnant women, mother and/or guardian, will be entered into HMIS-Nutrition App by the health center staff ⁹ providing services to the candidate;
- In the event that a pregnant woman, mother/guardian does not have an NID card, will be oriented to his/her local authority (SEDO) for facilitation;
- A youth (volunteer) allocated to each NSDS implementing health center will be facilitating and monitoring quality and regularity of data entry at health center level on regular basis;
- MEIS will retrieve data of potential recipients from the Health management information system (HMIS)/Nutrition module and will therefore maintain a dynamic list of possible recipients that tracks the age of children and incorporates newly pregnant eligible women as and when they are identified;
- Recorded recipients' data will be automatically transferred into LODA MEIS to allow sector staff to recognize potential NSDS recipients on time;

⁹ The health center staff may be a nurse, midwife and nutritionist depending on the utilized health unit

- The health center data managers will be checking quality assurance of data transferred into MEIS (missing preconditions) on a weekly basis, identify all cases missing preconditions and then share the report with concerned staff at health center/or sector level for correction;
- On quarterly basis (September, December, March and June), the sector management meeting will review, update and approve the list of NSDS recipients, imported from HMIS, based on socio economic conditions of each household recipients;
- The sector will submit the approved payrolls (maintained into the system) to the District and request for cash transfer.

4.2.4. Payment principles and procedures

4.2.4.1. Payment Principles

- NSDS recipients are entitled to RWF10,000 per month, transferred on a quarterly basis (30,000Rwf), irrespective of whether a pregnant woman also has an eligible child or whether a mother has more than one eligible child or whether a guardian has more than one eligible child, except a mother with twins who will get a double monthly payment of Rwf10,000. Twins¹⁰ should be treated differently from other children to promote birth spacing and other good family planning practices;
- Payments shall be made directly by district to the pregnant woman or mother/guardian of the eligible infant. Eligible women/mothers/guardians are entitled to open their personal accounts with their local formal financial institutions for this purpose;
- Entitlements will be calculated for each full month after the date of enrolment i.e. if an individual enrolls mid-month (after 15th of the month), their entitlement shall commence from the beginning of the following month;
- No deductions whatsoever shall be made from NSDS payments during the payment process except on recipient order supported by a signed individual consent.
- Payments must be made to the recipients not later than 10th (calendar days) of the first month following the quarter under consideration i.e 10th of October, January, April and July;¹¹

4.2.4.2. Fund requests

Funds for NSDS should be requested on quarterly basis,

- District should request 25% of annual budget ceiling in Q1, Q2 and Q3 while in Q4, District will request needed budget but not exceeding the annual ceiling budget.
- District should ensure that the budget for NSDS is included in cash flow plan to allow the request of funds from MINECOFIN.
- Districts are also encouraged to use funds from Development Partners before funds from MINECOFIN.

Supporting document

¹⁰ Twins is considered as more than one child with the same date of birth and being born from the same mother

¹¹ In the event that an individual is enrolled after the previous payment cycle has been processed but before the start of the new quarter, they will receive payments for the quarter due (e.g. if a mother enrolls in mid-September, they will receive their first payment in December and but will receive 3 months of payments October, November and December).

Quarter	Supporting document
Q1	1. Requesting letter from District 2. Approved transfer request report from MEIS
Q2 & Q3 & Q4	1. Requesting letter from District 2. Approved transfer request report from MEIS 3. Financial report of received NSDS funds from previous quarter

4.2.5. Co-responsibilities

4.2.5.1. Health coresponsibilities

- Once a household has been enrolled on the scheme, they are expected to fulfil the following co-responsibilities.

Recipients group	Responsibilities
Pregnant women	8 Ante-natal Care (ANC) visits during pregnancy but 4 ANC will be monitored through MEIS
Newborn children aged 0-42 days	Complete 2 Post Natal Care (PNC) visits at health center - At birth and week 6
Children 3.5 -18 months old	Attend 6 growth monitoring / height-for-age measurement visits at a health facility as follows: - Visit 1 (3.5 months after birth) - Visit 2 (6 months after date of birth) - Visit 3 (9 months after date of birth) - Visit 4 (12 months after date of birth) - Visit 5 (15 months after date of birth) - Visit 6 (18-24months after date of birth)

4.2.5.2. Household welfare related co-responsibilities

Household with members who are supported through Nutrition Sensitive Direct Support, are all expected to spend benefit for enhancing their family welfare by:

- Spending the benefit to food related items in order to have adequate food for their children and family member.
- Preventing malnutrition among under five children by preparing adequate meal for pregnant women and children;

After 2 quarters under support households benefiting from NSDS are all expected to:

- Breed small livestock's like chicken which will produce eggs and organic fertilizer;
Plant at least two fruit trees;
- Maintaining a productive kitchen garden with various vegetables;
- Improving latrine and WASH (water, sanitation and hygiene) by using a proportion of support to buy hygienic materials;

4.2.6. Complementary interventions:

Along the implementation of the Nutrition Sensitive Direct Support, community members will benefit from mass community socialization campaign from competent institutions (RBC, NCDA, etc) and relevant actors (community health workers, local authorities, ECD-Sector supervisor) on issues of early childhood development, nutrition and other relevant programmes and services, including ante- and post-natal health care services, child growth monitoring.

4.2.7. Coordination with other social protection schemes

The NSDS is specifically intended to support consumption among extremely poor pregnant women and children. The wider household shall therefore remain eligible for any other social protection benefits that target the households as a whole, including VUP Direct Support, Expanded Public Works, Home Based ECDs and Classic Public Works.

4.3. Implementation arrangements

4.3.1. Implementing Agencies

4.3.1.1. Local Administrative Entities Development Agency (LODA)

- Mobilize resources for NSDS implementation from government, development partners and other stakeholders.
- Provide planning guidance and budget ceilings for NSDS for each targeted Districts on an annual basis
- In collaboration with RBC, NCDA and NIDA, and consistent with the broad design aspects of the program, prepare detailed implementation guidelines which shall include, among others, definition of: the target group; eligibility criteria; geographical coverage; registration mechanism; documents required for registration; benefit value; payment processes and mechanisms; co-responsibilities and actions to be taken in case of non-compliance; grievances management; case management and internal monitoring;
- In partnership with RBC, NCDA and NIDA, train Districts, Sectors, health facilities cells, villages staff¹² and community health workers on NSDS scheme design and implementation modalities ;
- Provide quality assurance of NSDS Recipient enrollment and payment processes, including monitoring timeliness of payment delivery;
- Ensure timely disbursement and delivery of funds to Districts for NSDS Recipient payments;
- Prepare periodic consolidated reports on NSDS implementation progress and furnish them to the relevant government authorities and Development Partners;

4.3.1.2. National Childhood Development Agency (NCDA)

- Provide technical support to the design of the NSDS and the complementary social behavioural change communication campaign;
- Coordinate the capacity building plans and trainings of RBC, LODA and NCDA on NSDS;
- Participate in the monitoring, evaluation of Nutrition Sensitive Direct Support Scheme and ensure that lessons learnt are integrated into improvement of the scheme.
- Lead the NSDS impact evaluation: baseline survey, mid-line survey and end line survey.

4.3.1.3. Local Governments

Role and responsibilities of Districts

- Coordinate the implementation of the NSDS and its associated activities (e.g. birth registration, Recipient registration-enrolment, Nutrition/health services provision etc) in accordance with guidelines issued by LODA, MoH, RBC, NCDA and NIDA;
- Coordinate the implementation of the mobilization and SBCC campaign for pregnant women, mothers, fathers and caregivers of children below 2 years of age for uptake of the nutrition, health and WASH services in accordance with guidelines issued by NCDA and RBC;

¹² Staff refer to any person find relevant for the smooth implementation of Nutrition Sensitive Direct Support

- Ensure that NSDS Recipient registration at health centre, enrolment at the sector level and payments to the Recipients are conducted in a timely manner;
- Conduct supervision of health centres to monitor the uptake of health and nutrition services by Recipients at health centres;
- Ensure that the NSDS is coordinated with other programs and services at local level, working through the DPEM Committees where relevant.
- Ensure that NSDS Recipients are well mobilized to form learning groups and associations.

Role and responsibilities at Sector level

(a) Role of Executive secretary, sector social affairs and health officer

- Coordinate the implementation of the NSDS and its associated activities at sector level;
- Ensure that NSDS Recipient registration at health centre, enrolment and payment at the sector level are executed in a timely manner;
- Ensure that all new born are registered and issued with birth certificates and national unique identifiers as per the regulations;
- Ensure the NSDS data recorded at health center level is regularly entered into the system and in complete manner;
- On quarterly basis (September, December, March and June), the sector management meeting will review, update and approve the list of NSDS recipients
- Conduct supervision of health centres to monitor the uptake of health and nutrition services by NSDS Recipients;
- Ensure that NSDS Recipients are well mobilized to form learning groups and associations;
- Facilitate and participate in follow up of Recipients in cases of non-compliance with ANC/PNC/and growth monitoring attendance schedules;

(b) Role of Cell Executive Secretaries SEDOs and Village Coordinators

- Support community sensitisation activities, ensuring that all community members understand well NSDS objectives and implementation procedures
- Provide NSDS applicants without an NID with a letter of introduction to the Sector for application number and follow up on the case of any applicant lacking a NID to ensure this is resolved quickly.
 - Support eligible women/mothers to raise complaints where necessary
 - Investigate any cases of non-compliance with co-responsibilities, provide feedback on the reason for non-compliance to the Sector and encourage compliance.

4.3.1.4. Decentralized District Health Structures

Health Centres

- Ensure that all eligible pregnant women and children under two years of age are mobilized for Nutrition Sensitive Direct Support;
- Ensure that ANC/PNC, growth monitoring services attendance data is entered into the HMIS-Nutrition App accurately and in a timely manner.
- Analyze ANC/PNC, growth monitoring attendance data to identify all cases of non-compliance with a view to ensuring well-targeted outreach through CHWs and local government structures.
- Engage community Health Workers (CHWs) and local leaders to conduct the mass mobilization on the NSDS and other matters related to maternal and child nutrition and follow up on any eligible women missing out on NSDS support.

Role of CHWs

- Sensitize women/mothers/guardians on the core objectives of the NSDS and Recipients' responsibilities emphasizing on the importance of ante- and post-natal health checks;
- Facilitate Follow up Recipients in cases of non-compliance with ANC/PNC/and growth monitoring attendance schedules

4.3.1.5. Youth Volunteer services to support the implementation of NSDS at health center level

LODA in collaboration with RBC/Ministry of health and District will support to allocate a youth volunteer at health center to facilitate the implementation of the NSDS.

a) Roles and responsibilities

The youth volunteer will work collaboratively with relevant health center staff (data manager, Nutritionist and a nurse providing ANC, PNC and growth monitoring services) and sector staff (social affairs). Her /His first supervisor is the head of health center seconded by the sector social affairs and then Directors of Social Development Unit at District level. The youth coordinator at District level reserves the right of the overall supervision of youth under this task.

At each health center level, He/she will accomplish the following responsibilities:

- Monitor and ensure quality of NSDS Recipients' data entered into the nutrition app and on regularly basis;
- Support the regularly entry of the NSDS data (ANC, PNC and growth monitoring) into the HMIS;
- Enhance the awareness of the core objectives of the NSDS among Recipients and general community
- Support the sector office in preparation of quarterly payrolls
- Receive and manage claims and complaints from eligible NSDS Recipients
- Attend meeting related to the implementation of the NSDS at sector/health center level and at District level if needed.

b) Facilitation of youth volunteers

The youth volunteer who supports the health center in data entry will be facilitated with a monthly net incentives equivalent of 70,000 FRW including Frw 10,000 for communication fees.

4.3.2. Coordination and reporting requirements

The NSDS scheme shall be integrated into the agenda of the quarterly Sector and District-level coordination activities to allow effective implementation of the scheme between different levels and monitoring of issues resolution. Sectors should incorporate the NSDS into their general quarterly reports to the districts. Districts should report the progress of some key activities on quarterly basis to LODA using a template annexed with these guidelines (Annex 2). LODA will incorporate the NSDS into its quarterly and annual reports to MINALOC and MINECOFIN.

5. Classic Public Works

5.1. Introduction

This section provides detailed guidelines on the planning, implementation and reporting of the VUP Classic Public Works scheme. All 30 districts are covered with a given number of sectors depending on the available budget.

5.2. Eligibility criteria and priorities

- Households, with at least one person with labour capacity, living in extreme poverty/ poverty with no assets (lands, livestock, forest, ...) or the income from those assets is not sufficient to allow the members of households to satisfy their basic needs, or the household survive from informal casual work,
- Residing in a sector for at least 6 months and
- Not benefiting from either Direct Support, Old Age Grant or Expanded Public Works;

Note 1. Wherever possible, at least 50% of households participating in a Classic Public Works project should be female-headed.

Note 2. VUP cPW participant households will only be allowed to send one worker per day to the project site.

5.3. cPW project implementation

5.3.1. Annual targeting and enrolment procedures

Step 1: Annual approval of cPW-eligible HHs list by Sector Council

- (a) The provisional targeting list (PTL) of cPW recipients is generated from the dynamic social registry and compare it with the previous financial year list of recipients;
- (b) Districts and sectors, using the community meeting/ consultation, verify the changes of each household socio-economic status and make adjustment to PTL;
- (c) The adjustments are due to death of household member able to work, removal of improved household in socio economic status i.e having source of income as there are supported in two previous years under this scheme, relocated households, additional of new households complying with eligibility criteria;
- (d) The final targeting list is approved by Sector council;
- (e) The approved targeting list is entered into the system used to monitor the implementation of this scheme;

Note 1. In the event of insufficient resources, the eligible recipients meet and select the ones who will participate in cPW starting by those who are extremely poor than others.

Note 2. Households that are selected to be part of **graduation programme who fulfill the eligibility criteria** should be prioritized for cPW employment in two years

Step 2: Selection of workers and Capitas¹³

Public procurement regulations require that a community¹⁴ meeting is convened at the outset of the Community Procurement process. In the context of VUP cPW, the purpose of this meeting is to:

- i. Orient community members on the VUP Classic Public Works scheme;
- ii. Verify the eligibility of households on the cPW Targeting List (TL) (see example TL in **Annex I**);

¹³ A person who lead a team of 25 to 30 individuals working in public works activities

¹⁴ Community refers to eligible recipients approved by Sector council to be employed under cPW

- iii. Nominate priority households to participate and confirm their willingness to work (this to include identifying any households that have been affected by a severe shock and that the community feel should be able to access Classic Public Works);
- iv. Collect any missing National ID data and bank/SACCO/ account details and Phone number of nominated households;
- v. The community should also nominate potential **Capitas** that comply with the minimum requirements. If a suitable candidate cannot be found from within the cPW-eligible households, then a suitable individual with labor capacity but have limited assets to sustain their livelihoods should be nominated depending on the techniques required.

All decisions, including any cases where a cPW-eligible household is unable to participate in cPW due to caring responsibilities, should be documented using the approved '**cPW community Minutes format**' (See Annex I).

Selection of Capitas

- i. One capita should be recruited for every 30 recipients;
- ii. Capitas should, wherever possible, be selected from among the cPW-eligible households.
- iii. Capitas should be nominated by the selected workers (so after worker selection has been completed)
- iv. Capitas should be literate, have basic numeracy, demonstrate integrity and capable of fulfilling the role of a Capita for the duration of the cPW project implementation.
- v. Nomination of Capitas shall be documented on the cPW Provisional Targeting List template (See Annex I)

Step 3: Finalization of recipient selection, election of community representative and nomination of Site supervisor

The Sector will convene a meeting at sector level for all households selected to participate in the cPW project(s). The purpose of this meeting is to:

- i. Resolve any discrepancies between project worker requirements and number of households selected;
- ii. Inform participants on their roles and responsibilities;
- iii. Collect participants' Bank/SACCO account numbers and National ID numbers which were not available during the community meeting (to be added to the blank columns on the Targeting List);
- iv. Elect a community representative (to sign the contract on behalf of the community) and Site supervisor. Selection of the community representative and Site supervisor shall be documented in the minutes.

Step 4: Sector Management Meeting approves recipient selection, capita nominations and Community representatives

Nominations of cPW's workers, community representatives, Site supervisor and Capitas should be presented for approval to the Sector Management meeting.

Step 5: Enrolment of selected recipients into a project in MEIS

The Sector authorities shall submit the approved recipient list to the district. The district will:

- i. review the recipient list and ensure all documentation is present and correct, and
- ii. authorize enrolment of selected recipients within MEIS.

The targeting list should be entered into MEIS within 10 days of its approval by the Sector.

Step 6: Preparation and signing of Community Representative contract.

The district will prepare two copies of the cPW contract using the Sample Community Representative Contract Format (**Annex 9**) and submit to the District Executive Secretary for signature. The community representative shall then sign the contract. One copy shall be provided to the Community Representative while the other copy shall be filed securely in the district.

5.4. Removal of a household from a classic Public Works project:

A household may only be permanently removed from a VUP classic Public Works project if any of the following apply:

- a) The household moves to a different sector;
- b) All of the household's workers die or migrate;
- c) A household does not attend the Public Works project site for more than 10 days consecutively and does not have a reasonable justification (i.e. unavoidable circumstances such as temporary sickness).

In the event that a household is removed from a VUP Classic Public Works project, the Community Representative should convene a community meeting to nominate a replacement from eligible households and then reported to Sector using '**cPW Household Removal and Replacement Form**' (See Annex 5).

5.5. Procurement

Procurement for the following will be conducted by the district:

- i. Activities to be executed by cPW participants Households using the 'Community Procurement' method;
- ii. Materials and tools including safeguards equipments;

Procurement for VUP classic Public Works projects shall be conducted as per government procurement legislation. Tools to be procured by District are the materials which cPW recipients are not able to have themselves including wheelbarrow, pics, speds, tridents.

5.6. Fund requests

Funds for VUP Public Works projects shall be disbursed in two tranches as follows:

Tranches	Disbursement value	Disbursement trigger
Tranche 1:	100% of materials and equipment budget plus 50% of labour budget	Signing of contract with contractor or community Representative.
Tranche 2:	Remaining budget	Expenditure of at least 70% of labour budget (sent in tranche 1) and works progress report.

Districts will request funds early in the financial year so that (i) on-going projects can be finished in a timely way and (ii) new projects can be mobilised early. **This should be done at the start of the financial year for on-going projects.**

5.6.1. Requesting funds from LODA

Districts shall submit the following supporting documentation when making a funds request from LODA as set out in Box 9.

Box 9. Supporting documentation for CPW funds requisitions (to be provided officially to LODA on this email: info@loda.gov.rw) Tenders awarded to the community

First instalment

- Letter of request
- Transfer Request Report generated from MEIS
- Contract between the district and the community representative
- Evaluation report by the district tender committee
- Supervision contract

Second installments

- Letter of request by the district
- Transfer Request Report generated from MEIS
- Works Progress report
- Financial report and justifications (copy of Payment voucher)

For contracts related to supply of materials

- Letter of request
- Transfer Request Report generated from MEIS
- Copy of the signed contract

NB: The following documents should be uploaded into MEIS where the transfer request report is generated and serve as supporting documents for cPW funds requests:

a. Tenders awarded to the community related documents

- i. Copy of simplified Feasibility Assessment
- ii. Minutes for the election of the community representative, capita, supervisor and the list of participants (names and signatures)
- iii. Approved simplified or full Environmental and Social Management Plan (ESMP-signed by DEO, verified by Dir SDU and approved by District Executive Secretary)
- iv. Livelihood Restoration Plans (if required) for Radical Terraces projects
- v. Report on the establishment/election of Grievance committee with attendance list of participants

b. For contracts related to supply of materials

- i. Copy of the invitation to tender that put in a news paper
- ii. Copy of tender document
- iii. Copy of the bidding document of the successful bidder
- iv. Copy of the evaluation report by the internal tender committee
- v. Copy of the final notification letter
- vi. Copy of final contract

5.6.2. Requesting funds from MINECOFIN

- District should ensure that the budget for cPW is included in cash flow plan to allow the request of funds from MINECOFIN.
- Districts are also encouraged to use funds from Development Partners before funds from MINECOFIN.

5.7. Training of workers at start of the project

Relevant District or Sector technical staff (Engineers, Infrastructure Officers, and Agronomists etc) shall deliver on-site training to workers and Capitas at the start of the cPW project. Training should cover:

- i. Relevant norms and technical standards defined by relevant line ministry for that type of infrastructure
- ii. Health and safety

- iii. The roles and responsibilities of workers, Capitas and site supervisor
- iv. Attendance requirements and record keeping
- v. Complaint's procedures
- vi. Code of conduct

5.8. The role of Capitas in project implementation

During project implementation, Capitas shall be responsible for:

- i. Task distribution amongst the recipients that they are responsible for;
- ii. Ensure compliance with technical norms and standards
- iii. Keeping daily records of public works attendance using the Public Works Attendance List (Annex 6).
- iv. Participating in project progress review meetings with the Site Supervisor and sector officials
- v. Reporting to Community representative and Site Supervisor daily

5.9. The role of Community Representatives in project implementation

During project implementation, Community Representatives shall be responsible for the following:

- i. Workforce organization and supervision;
- ii. Submission of monthly progress reports (and any other reports required) to Sector;
- iii. Submission of consolidated attendance lists to the Sector every 10 working days
- iv. Verify daily records of public works attendance
- v. Collect the attendance after 10 days Entry of recipients's data related to their days worked

5.10. Roles and requirements for Site Supervisors

5.10.1. Roles and responsibilities of site supervisor

The Sector should agree with a suitably qualified Site Supervisor to supervise the cPW project. Site Supervisors are responsible for ensuring compliance with project requirements as set out in the project contract. They should also deliver skills training to participants in their area of technical expertise and importantly ensure that attendance list is entered into MEIS to produce the payroll after every 10 days working cycle.

5.10.2. Requirements for site supervisors

Site supervisors should fulfil the following conditions:

- Having at least A level (A2) in technical domains of cPW projects like Agronomy, construction, forestry, etc;
- Having knowledge in IT
- Resident within sector and from cPW eligible household is a priority

During selection,

- People with disability are given first priority;
- Women are given second priority
- Youth are given third priority

Note 1: In the event where there is no candidate in a Sector, candidates from neighboring sectors may be considered

Note 2: The facilitation of PW site supervisor is 70,000 Frw including 10,000Frw of communication that will be on monthly basis as stipulated in signed contract with District Executive secretary (**see annex 11**).

5.11. Wage payment principles and procedures

- Classic Pubic Works wages/payments must be made within 15 calendar days from the end of the 10-days work cycle.
- All payments **MUST** be processed through MEIS.
- Ensure the verification of recipients' full identification is carried out before any payment is made, whereby a payment with names and identification are not matching, that recipients must be not paid.
- Payments will be made to the individual recipients' Accounts from District.
- No deductions shall be made from VUP cPW payments during the payment process, except bank/SACCO charges and/or on recipient order supported by a signed individual consent.

5.12. Livelihood restoration for land owners under Radical teraaces projects

During the establishment of radical terraces, land owners are restricted to use their land. In the framework of livelihood restoration, the land owners are supported in:

- Availing the budget for establishment of radical terraces
- Training on basic agricultural and livestock practices/ management skills
- Provide agriculture inputs including lime and organic manure (for at least one agriculture season)

5.13. Monitoring and reporting of cPW projects

5.13.1. Monitoring of cPW sites

Each cPW project shall be supervised by a relevant technician from the Sector depending on its nature. This technician should conduct regular visits to the cPW sites to ensure compliance with technical, environmental, health and safety standards.

5.13.2. Reporting requirements

Community representatives and site supervisor shall submit a monthly progress reports (**Annex 10**) approved by the sector to the district, while site supervisor shall submit bi-weekly progress reports to the Sector.

5.13.3. Project closure

Upon completion of a VUP Public Works project, the Community Representative shall complete a **completion Report (Annex 12)** with support from the Site Supervisor. The district shall then establish a committee to review the status of the cPW project and approve the report.

6. Grievance Redress Mechanism and Case Management

6.1. Overview and objectives

The Grievance Redressal and Case Management system is a social accountability mechanism that will be used to foster a collaborative approach in receiving, addressing, and responding to the different social protection programs related complaints and appeals.

It will be part of the project implementation, and aims to:

- Resolve all grievances emanating from the project activities in a timely manner;
- Establish relationships of trust between project staff and stakeholders and Guide project stakeholders (i.e., MINALOC, LODA, Districts, Social protection partners and recipients) on their key functions, roles and responsibilities to better implement the project;
- Create transparency among stakeholders including affected persons through an established communication system;
- Booster the relationship of trust amongst the project staff and the affected parties
- Enable recipients and non-recipients to understand the procedures to lodge appeals, complaints as well as mechanisms for updates

6.2. Types of grievances/ appeals/ feedback

There are various grievances that are likely to occur during the implementation of social protection projects. In accordance with Social Protection Programs, grievances/ appeals or forms of feedback that might arise include the Grievance related:

- To lack of information about the projects
- To errors in recipient data
- To exclusion from the registration process i.e exclusion from social protection program
- To lack of assistance for individuals with disabilities
- To recipients entitlement (left off the payroll, receiving wrong amount, having fees deducted illegitimately)
- To social protection program staff who disrespect or abuse the program recipients
- To Gender Based Violence, sexual exploitation and abuse, harassment
- To all forms of discrimination, corruption, and fraud
- To construction works including such as noise, dust, vibration, workers' disputes among others
- To land acquisition, land boundaries, valuation/compensation, income or livelihood loss;
- Misuse of funds;
- Complaints about project staff;
- Complaints about procurement by contractors;
- Complaints about Contractor performance

6.3. Grievance redress mechanism process

Following are procedures for initiating, handling, monitoring and providing feedback or complaints that may rise during the implementation social protection programs:

6.3.1. Initiation

This step refers to the methods by which the project will collect grievances or feedback. It includes uptake locations and channels, language for submission, form for filing grievances as well as filer and receiver of the grievances.

Location for filing complaint or feedback

Communities and/or individuals who believe that have grievances, complaints, questions, feedback or suggestions may submit them at any level of the project implementation structure:

- At cell, sector and district levels where project is being implemented;
- At LODA
- At MINALOC

Channels for raising complaints or feedback

All complaints or feedback can be channeled via:

- Phone calls, Text messages,
- Meetings, Proactive outreach,
- Letters, Verbal narration,
- Emails, Suggestion, boxes,
- Reports on visits to project sites by project staff, independent monitors, supervision team, government
- Findings of World Bank supervision and implementation support missions
- WB's Grievance Redress Service (GRS) as well as WB's independent Inspection Panel
- Call in questions, comments, or complaints from radio programs
- Media articles or other publications

Language for raising/submission of complaint or feedback

Individuals and community members may submit feedback/grievances in the language of their choice.

Form for filing the complaint/feedback

The feedback or grievance can be given orally or in writing (soft or hard copies). Whenever possible and for documentation purposes, grievance redress form (annex 21) will be used.

Transmitter of the complaint/feedback

Anyone shall be able to lodge a complaint and different methods (in person, telephone, email, social media, website, forms written in local language, suggestion boxes, among others) shall be used. They can also report their concerns through third parties and provided communication channels should not inhibit the lodgment of any complaint. Here are some tips that can be used by the GRC in order to encourage community members to submit complaints:

- Ensuring that communication materials are prepared and distributed widely to raise awareness of the existence of the GRM;
- Ensuring that it is free to report a complaint;
- Ensure Members of the Grievance Redress Committee are trained on how to receive and address the complaints;
- Confidentiality of complainants is observed;
- GRC members should help potential complainants write their grievances if needed.

Receiver of the complaint/feedback

Generally, Grievance Redress Committees and all project staff are authorized to receive grievances. Particularly, grievances that will be sent via:

- Emails will be received by the staff involved in project implementation;

- Hotline, media and articles will be received by the Communication team of MINALOC and LODA

6.3.2. Sort and Process

Various types of grievances/feedback typically require different follow-up actions i.e some can be resolved by means of a simple explanation or apology, while others may require more extensive investigations. Therefore, this is the step where Grievance Redress Committee categorize grievances, assign priority, and route them to the appropriate entity. However, all forms of grievance have to be recorded with specific dates and how they were resolved and reported to the LODA and MINALOC.

6.3.2.1. Categorization

Grievances and feedback can be categorized in four main types:

- Comments, suggestions, or queries;
- Complaints relating to nonperformance of project obligations;
- Complaints referring to violations of law and/or corruption; and
- Complaints against program staff or community members involved in program management.

6.3.2.2. Prioritization

There is a need to assess urgency and prioritize the complaints to know which need to be addressed immediately or if they can follow the provided timeframe for redress. Cases that need to be addressed immediately include GBV cases, health incidents, fraud and corruption among others.

Issues to consider may include:

- What effect does it have on an individual's or a group's welfare and safety?
- Does it have the negative impact on the implementation timeframe of the project?
- Is it attracting much public attention?

6.3.2.3. Assigning appropriate entity

After prioritization, grievances should be directed to the appropriate entity/ GRC for resolution.

▪ Complaints related to NSDS Scheme

Complaints related to incorrect or incomplete data within the Nutrition App- FBF MIS (which has resulted in exclusion or suspension of payments) shall be directed, in the first instance, to the health center. In the event that the health center fails to address the complaint satisfactorily, the recipient may escalate their complaint to the Sector that shall be responsible for investigating and engaging the health center on behalf of the recipient and ensuring that data is corrected and that feedback is provided to the recipient.

The Sector Social Affairs Officer should keep a register within MEIS (appeals and complains module) of all grievances received, track their resolution and ensure that feedback is provided to the persons submitting the complaint. In the event that it is impossible to resolve a grievance

at sector level, the Sector or the complainant themselves should escalate the issue to the district, which should investigate the case and advise the Sector accordingly.

In the event that local government fails to resolve a grievance satisfactorily and within a reasonable period of time, the complaint should be escalated to MINALOC or LODA. However, the final authorities on eligibility for the NSDS scheme shall remain with the Sector and health center.

▪ **Grievance Channel for Gender-Based Violence**

When GBV related complaint including sexual harassment is received at the first or second tier of GRM, the complaint should be kept confidential by the person receiving the complaint, and the complaint will be immediately reported to Isange One Stop Center (IOSC), a national police-led center established to provide comprehensive support to victims of GBV. The complaint should be reported to the relevant committee and immediate actions should be taken that is consistent with the wishes and choices, rights and dignity of the complainant. The complainant should be given information in simple and clear terms on the steps for filing complaints and the possible outcomes, the timelines and the types of supports available to be able to make informed decision.

For GBV cases, it is important to ensure that access to the complaints processes is as easy and as safe as possible for the complainant survivor. The recording of incidence should be limited to the nature of complaint put exactly in the words of the complainant, the age of the survivor and if to the best of their knowledge, the perpetrator was associated with the program. The complainant should decide on whether they would like to be referred to the grievance committee and the complainant should give consent to share basic monitoring data.

▪ **Court of law**

If GRM failed to resolve the complaints, the Complainant will have the right to take the matter to the appropriate legal or judicial authority as per Rwanda National Legal procedure. However, the complainant is advised to start by mediation committee (Abunzi) if the complaint falls under this structure.

6.3.3. Acknowledge and follow up

When a complaint is made, the GRC should acknowledge its receipt in a communication that outlines the grievance process; provides contact details and, if possible, the name of the contact person who is responsible for handling the grievance; and notes how long it is likely to take to resolve the grievance. Complainants will then receive periodic updates on the status of their grievances in the stipulated time for resolution as per the duration provided.

6.3.4. Investigate and act

This step involves gathering information about the grievance to determine its validity, and resolving the grievance.

6.3.4.1. Verification and Investigation

This step includes gathering of facts and clarifying information in order to have a clear picture of the circumstances surrounding the grievance or complaint. In this regard, the GRC should

decide which team members will be responsible for fact-finding and should ensure that they are neutral and do not have any stake in the outcome of the investigation.

The selected members should try to:

- Identify the parties involved in the case
- Clear issues and concerns raised by the complaint
- Collect views of other stakeholders, including those of social protection programs if needed

6.3.4.2. Taking action

This step reflects the action and decision-making process that will be done at different levels. The GRC should be open to looking at different ways to addressing grievances. In general, the GRCs should review existing resolution methods when deciding on which way to appropriate response. Where applicable, even traditional methods that are fair should be applied.

Potential action includes either:

- Responding to a query, comment or suggestion, imposing sanctions or
- Referring the grievance to an appropriate level of the system

Note that the GRCs should resolve a complaint when it is straightforward, the issue is clear and that it can be resolved at that level.

6.3.5. Monitor and evaluate

This step refers to the process of tracking grievances and assessing the extent to which progress is being made to resolve them. In order to assess the extent to which the desired objectives of GRM are being realized and inform decision making in case adjustments that might be needed in handling complaints raising due to social protection program implementation, the key performance indicators are:

- (i) Number of grievances received,
- (ii) Percentage of grievance resolved, and
- (iii) Percentage of grievances redressed within stipulated time period.

In order to measure those indicators, a Complaints/Feedback Register will be maintained by the committees and safeguards staff, who will log the:

- (i) details and nature of the complaint;
- (ii) the complainant name and their contact details;
- (iii) date; and
- (iv) corrective actions taken in response to the complaint.

Specifically, the following indicator of the social protection program's results framework will be utilized: ***Grievances registered related to delivery of project benefits that are addressed***. This indicator will measure the utilization of GRM by reporting on percentage of number addressed grievances in comparison to number of grievances received.

6.3.6. Provide feedback

This step refers to the process of informing the complainant or aggrieved party about the status of the complaint or provision of information required by the project stakeholder. Any questions, procedures, findings and proposed actions should be translated into a language that

the complainant understands. Depending on the nature of complaints, the GRC should decide on the appropriate means of communication. If the complainant is known, feedback can be provided directly. GRM users will be informed about their right to an appeal if they are dissatisfied with the decision. The complainant may file an appeal to the next higher level of the grievance redress system or to an appropriate office. The national Grievance Redress Committee is the highest level in the GRM and their decision is final, unless the complainant wishes to take their grievance to other relevant government agencies (e.g., courts, Office of the Ombudsman, etc.)

6.3.7. Confidentiality in Grievance Documentation

Records of grievances including information such as gender, age and location, makes grievance management easier. This information, however, should be protected from unauthorized people and the GRCs should always protect complainants' confidentiality.

6.2. Establishment of Grievance Redress Committee (GRC)

During social protection program implementation, people may be affected during the project or not gain the benefits that they were expected to obtain from the project. To better address the related complaints, it is planned to establish grievance redress committee with a purpose of resolving complaints and dissatisfaction of program affected people in a timely manner.

6.2.1. National level Grievance Redress Committee (GRC)

The national GRC will be established at LODA and made up with different staff implementing each scheme (classic Public Works, expanded Public Works, Direct Support, Nutrition Sensitive Direct Support) communication and safeguard teams. Complainants should submit their complaints through emails, hotline or social media platform: E-mail: info@loda.gov.rw, Hotline: 5029, Tweet: @LODARwanda.

The grievance redress committee will be composed of the following members:

Chairperson:

The chairperson of the committee is the Division Manager of community development strategy and coordination division and has the following responsibilities:

- Invite and chair meetings of the committee,
- Communicate the action required from responsible parties for effecting the agreed upon responses;
- Serve as the spokesperson of the committee and report to the LODA management and its partners.

Co-chair person

The co chairs of the committee are the Program managers and Director of Social Protection Unit with the following responsibilities:

- Invite and chair the meeting in the absence of the chairperson;
- Assist the President in giving directions during meeting discussions;
- Serve as the spokesperson of the GRC and report to the LODA management and its partners in the absence of the President.

Secretary

The secretariate of the committee is a team composed by social safeguard team and communication team. While Social Safeguard specialist will lead the team and serve as minutes' taker during the meetings and filing all documents related to the GRM, Communication staff will receive and record grievance received through social media and hotline in a logbook.

6.2.2. Community and Lower-Level Grievance Redress committee

Principales of GRC

- The chairperson of GRC could invite any staff whose responsibilities matches with the complaints and dissatisfaction raised
- The maximum number of days for resolving a complaint or dissatisfaction is **14 days from** its reception if it doesn't compromise the judicial process.
- If the complaint is not addressed to within 14 days, the complaint is referred to the next GRC at high level.
- GRC members meet when there is complaints or dissatisfaction to be addressed. Some of complaints and dissatisfaction can be addressed immediately without conducting a meeting if possible.
- GRC meeting can be hold face to face or online

Level I: Sector level GRC

There will be committees in the communities and these will start at Sector level as social protection projects are sector based. The Grievance Redress Committee is elected during community consultation meetings held between the District/Sector/Cell officials and the Project Affected People (PAPs)/ recipients. The GRC is composed by the following members:

Grievance Redress committee's members (GRC)			
Elected members		Non elected members	
Representatives elected by participants of: 1. <u>cPW</u> 2. <u>ePW</u> 3. HBECD 4. NSDS 5. DS 6. OAG 7. <u>Parasocial</u> workers 8. Volunteers in NSDS 9. Volunteers in HBECD 10. Volunteers in NGOs	 <i>The GRC is sector based and the number members of the committee depend on the number of scheme implemented within sector</i>	1. Sector Social Affairs officer 2. Sector Land Management officer 3. Sector Agronomist 4. Representative of Women 5. Representative of Youth 6. Representative of <u>PwD</u>	Other members to be invited if needed: 1. The SEDO of cell where the complainant is located 2. Staff from Isange One Stop Center on the GBV issues 3. Any other person needed to resolve the logged complaint/ grievance

- GRC's members meet and elect the Chair and Co-chair from elected members
- The secretary is from non elected members and is Sector social affairs
- The committee take resolutions when the column is 2/3 i.e 11 member but the Chair or co-chair and the scheme representative are mandatory depending on the source of complaints

Level II: District Level GRC

The committee will be composed of the following members namely the Vice Mayor in Charge of Social Affairs as Chairperson, Director of Social Development Unit as co chair, District Social Protection Officer who will be the Secretary, the District Environmental Officer, a Women Representative from the Unit of Social Protection who will also represent youth and vulnerable groups will be member of the committee. Though not part of the committee, Isange One Stop Centre Representative will participate in District GRC meetings whenever deemed necessary.

6.2.3. Facilitation of GRC's members

GRCs members will be trained at least once a quarter and will be entitled to a transportation allowance of 10,000rwfs as a facilitation to attend the training. In case there is a need to train the GRCs members from different District outside their respective Districts, in addition to the transportation allowances, they will be entitled to mission allowances. The mission allowances will be calculated basing on Ministerial Instructions N°001/15/10/TC of 20/07/2015 determining mission fees of public servants on official mission inside the country. In this case Grievance committee members will be considered as civil servant of level J/4, K/5 and L/6. Their respective Districts will provide them with Travel clearances and LODA/Districts, MINALOC or any other organizing/inviting institution among the social protection stakeholders will pay the mission allowances and transport.

Detailed Grievance redress process

Stage	Process	Duration
I	Step 1: The Aggrieved Party (AP) will take his/her grievance/complaint to Sector Grievance Committee and Register grievance (Email, letter, phone call, meeting, proactive outreach) Step 2: Acknowledgement (Within 24 hours) by GRC at sector level Step 3: Screening, sorting, assessment, and unrelated grievances are referred to appropriate organs. At this stage the AP with unrelated grievances is given feedback Step 4: Define and agreed on Redressal Approach and take decision to the grievance Step 5: Provide feedback to the AP and refer the non-resolved grievance to the GRC at District level Step 6: Appeals: If AP is not satisfied, the Sector Grievance Committee will refer the AP to the District GRC.	Immediately after receiving the complaint if possible but not later than two weeks (2 weeks) except GBV related complaints which are directly reported to Isange One Stop Center within 24 hours

Stage	Process	Duration
	Step 7: Monitoring of implementation on agreed action. For complaints that were satisfactorily resolved by the Sector GRC, the committee will inform the higher level of program management and they will log the grievance/complaint and the actions that were taken.	
2	Step 1: The Aggrieved Party (AP) will take his/her grievance or GRC at sector level refer the non-resolved grievance Step 2: Acknowledgement (Within 24 hours) by GRC at District level Step 3. Screening, sorting, assessment, and unrelated grievances are referred to appropriate organs. At this stage the AP with unrelated grievances is given feedback Step 4: Define and agreed on Redressal Approach and take decision to the grievance Step 5: Provide feedback to the AP and refer the non-resolved grievance to the GRC at LODA level. At this stage, the resolved cases are marked closed (form on annex 22 should be used) Step 6. Appeals: If AP is not satisfied, the District GRC	As soon as possible but not exceeding two weeks after receiving the complaint
3	Step 1: The Aggrieved Party (AP) will take his/her grievance or GRC at District level refer the non-resolved grievance to LODA GRC Step 2: Acknowledgement (Within 24 hours) by GRC at LODA level Step 3: Define and agreed on redressal Approach, take decision to the grievance and provide feedback Step 4: Provide feedback to the AP and refer the non-resolved grievance to the GRC at LODA level. At this stage the case the resolved cases are closed (form on annex 22 should be used) Step 5. Appeals: If unsuccessful, the AP will be allowed to take their complaints to the existing courts. Step 6: Monitoring of implementation on agreed action.	As soon as possible but not exceeding two weeks after receiving the complaint

Stage	Process	Duration
4	Unsatisfied complainants after the resolution from the SPIU will be allowed to take their complaints to the existing courts.	Any time after the resolution of the LODA GRC

7. Repealing provision and transitional

All the previous VUP operational manual (implementation guidelines) and other provisions contrary to these guidelines are hereby repealed except the summary in Kinyarwanda version of these guidelines issued by LODA. LODA has the Discretion to take any other measure as long as it does not contradict its mission and mandate stipulated by the law establishing LODA.

8. Commencement

This VUP safety nets operation manual (implementation guidelines) shall come into force on the date of the signing.

Done at Kigali on29/07/2023


Nyinawagaga Claudine
 Director General



Annexes

Annex 1. Minutes Format for Annual PTL Validation Meeting



Annex 1.docx

Annex 2. Feasibility Assessment for cPW



CPW SFAs by types.docx

Annex 3 . Sample ePW/ HBECD Sector Supervisor Contract



Annex 3.docx

Annex 4: Sample ePW Workers Contract (road maintenance)



Annex 4.docx

Annex 5: VUP Household Removal and Replacement Notification Form



Annex 5.docx

Annex 6: Sample Cell/ Site Supervisor Contract for ePW Projects (road maintenance)



Annex 6.docx

Annex 7: Ibirebwa mu gusura urugo mbonezamikurire y'abana bato



Annex 7.docx

Annex 8. Community/Home Based ECD Refurbishment Contract



Annex 8.docx

Annex 9: SAMPLE Community Representative Contract Format



Annex 9.docx

Annex 10: Community representative monthly report format (cPW)



Annex 10.docx

Annex 11: Sample Site Supervisor Contract-cPW



Annex 11.docx

Annex 12: Project Completion Report Format